

#1 · Values and Ethics

What is informed consent?

Answer

Informed consent means a client agrees to services after the social worker explains the purpose, risks, benefits, and alternatives in plain language. The client must have the capacity to choose, and they can refuse or stop at any time.

#2 · Values and Ethics

When can a social worker share confidential information without permission?

Answer

A social worker can share information without permission when a law requires it, such as suspected child abuse, a client who threatens to harm someone, or a court order. These limits should be explained to the client up front.

#3 · Values and Ethics

What is the HIPAA minimum necessary rule?

Answer

The minimum necessary rule says a worker shares only the smallest amount of protected health information needed for the task. Extra details that the receiver does not need should be left out.

#4 · Values and Ethics

What is mandatory reporting for suspected child abuse?

Answer

Social workers must report reasonable suspicion of child abuse or neglect to the authorities, even without proof. The report is required by law and does not need the client's permission.

#5 · Values and Ethics

What is mandatory reporting for suspected elder abuse?

Answer

Social workers must report suspected abuse, neglect, or exploitation of older adults in most states. The report usually goes to adult protective services or the police.

#6 · Values and Ethics

What is the duty to warn?

Answer

Duty to warn means a social worker must act to protect a specific person when a client makes a credible threat to harm them. This duty grew out of the Tarasoff case, and the exact rules vary by state.

#7 · Values and Ethics

Who is the client in a child custody evaluation?

Answer

In a child custody evaluation the client is the court, not the parents or the child. The evaluator gives neutral information to help the judge decide what is best for the child.

#8 · Values and Ethics

What is a dual relationship?

Answer

A dual relationship happens when a social worker has a second role with a client, such as friend, business partner, or romantic partner. These extra roles can hurt the client and cloud the worker's judgment, so they are usually avoided.

#9 · Values and Ethics

What is self-determination?

Answer

Self-determination is the client's right to make their own choices about their life and their services. Social workers support clients to decide, even when they personally disagree with the choice.

#10 · Values and Ethics

When can a social worker limit a client's self-determination?

Answer

A worker can limit self-determination only when the client's actions pose a serious, foreseeable, and imminent risk of harm to the client or others, or when specific laws require it. Agency policy alone is not a basis for limiting a client's self-determination.

#11 · Values and Ethics

What are the NASW core values?

Answer

The NASW names six core values: service, social justice, dignity and worth of the person, importance of human relationships, integrity, and competence. They guide how social workers make ethical choices.

#12 · Values and Ethics

What is an ethical dilemma?

Answer

An ethical dilemma is a situation where two or more ethical values conflict, so following one means giving up another. The worker weighs values, laws, and ethical guidance to make a thoughtful decision.

#13 · Values and Ethics

What is a microaggression?

Answer

A microaggression is a small, subtle comment or action that sends a demeaning message about a person's identity. It can be said on purpose or by accident.

#14 · Values and Ethics

What is privilege?

Answer

Privilege is unearned advantage a person has because of a group they belong to, such as race, class, or gender. People who have it often do not notice it.

#15 · Values and Ethics

What is implicit bias?

Answer

Implicit bias is an automatic attitude or stereotype that a person holds without knowing it. It can affect how a social worker treats a client even when the worker intends to be fair.

#16 · Values and Ethics

What is cultural humility?

Answer

Cultural humility is a lifelong commitment to learning about clients' cultures and reflecting on your own power and limits. It means treating the client as the expert on their own culture.

#17 · Values and Ethics

What is anti-oppressive practice?

Answer

Anti-oppressive practice actively looks at how systems of power and inequality affect clients. The worker partners with clients to name and challenge those barriers.

#18 · Values and Ethics

How should a social worker work with an interpreter?

Answer

Use a trained interpreter and speak directly to the client, not to the interpreter. Respect the client's preferred language and dialect, and avoid using family members for sensitive conversations when possible.

#19 · Values and Ethics

What does accessibility mean in social services?

Answer

Accessibility means removing barriers so people with disabilities can use services and spaces. It includes physical access, language, interpreters, and easy-to-read materials.

#20 · Values and Ethics

What does competence mean for a social worker?

Answer

Competence means a social worker only practices within their training and knowledge. Workers are expected to keep learning and to seek help or refer out when a case is beyond them.

#21 · Values and Ethics

What is exploitation or human trafficking?

Answer

Exploitation is using someone's labor, body, or resources for profit through force, fraud, or coercion. Trafficking can be sexual or labor, and victims may not see themselves as victims.

#22 · Values and Ethics

Why is self-care a professional duty for social workers?

Answer

Self-care protects workers from burnout and keeps them able to serve clients well. Looking after yourself is part of the job, not a selfish act.

#23 · Values and Ethics

What is secondary (vicarious) trauma?

Answer

Secondary trauma is stress a helper feels after hearing about a client's trauma. It can look like the client's own symptoms and can build over time.

#24 · Values and Ethics

What is burnout?

Answer

Burnout is emotional exhaustion, feeling detached from work, and losing a sense of accomplishment. It builds slowly with too much stress and too little support.

#25 · Values and Ethics

What should a social worker think about when a client offers a gift?

Answer

A small gift of thanks may be fine for some workers and agencies, but a large or unusual gift can create a conflict of interest. The worker should consider how the gift affects the relationship and may politely refuse.

#26 · Values and Ethics

What does the NASW value of service mean?

Answer

Service means helping people in need and giving time and skill to address social problems. It is the primary purpose of the social work profession.

#27 · Values and Ethics

What does social justice mean in social work?

Answer

Social justice means challenging unfair conditions such as poverty, discrimination, and unequal access to resources. Workers advocate for the rights of marginalized groups.

#28 · Values and Ethics

What is a boundary violation?

Answer

A boundary violation is a serious misuse of the professional role for the worker's benefit, such as a sexual relationship with a client. It is unethical and is not the same as a small boundary crossing.

#29 · Values and Ethics

What is a mandated reporter?

Answer

A mandated reporter is a professional who is required by law to report suspected abuse or neglect. Social workers are mandated reporters for children and, in many places, for vulnerable adults.

#30 · Values and Ethics

What should a worker do if a client is at risk of suicide?

Answer

Assess the risk and act to keep the client safe, which may mean involving emergency services or a crisis team. A clear safety plan and follow-up are part of the response.

#31 · Assessment and Planning

What is Erikson's trust versus mistrust stage?

Answer

It is the first stage, from birth to about 18 months. A baby learns trust when caregivers are consistent and responsive.

#32 · Assessment and Planning

What is Erikson's identity versus role confusion stage?

Answer

It happens during adolescence. Teens explore who they are and try on different roles, and success leads to a clearer sense of self.

#33 · Assessment and Planning

What is Erikson's intimacy versus isolation stage?

Answer

It happens in young adulthood. People form close, lasting relationships, or they can become isolated if they fear closeness.

#34 · Assessment and Planning

What is Piaget's concrete operational stage?

Answer

From about age 7 to 11, children think logically about real things and events. They can classify items and understand that amounts stay the same when they change shape.

#35 · Assessment and Planning

What is Kohlberg's postconventional level of morality?

Answer

At this level a person follows universal principles and their own conscience, even if a rule says otherwise. Right and wrong are based on principles, not just punishment or approval.

#36 · Assessment and Planning

What is secure attachment?

Answer

Secure attachment forms when a caregiver is consistently responsive to a child's needs. The child trusts the caregiver and can explore and then return for comfort.

#37 · Assessment and Planning

What is anxious-ambivalent attachment?

Answer

It can happen when a caregiver is sometimes available and sometimes not. The child tends to be clingy and hard to settle, fearing the caregiver will leave.

#38 · Assessment and Planning

What are adverse childhood experiences (ACEs)?

Answer

ACEs are stressful events before age 18, like abuse, neglect, or growing up in a disordered home. More ACEs raise the risk of later mental and physical health problems.

#39 · Assessment and Planning

What is acute trauma?

Answer

Acute trauma is a single, sudden event such as an assault, a car crash, or a disaster. It can still cause strong stress reactions and may need support.

#40 · Assessment and Planning

What is complex trauma?

Answer

Complex trauma is repeated or long-term harm, often in a family and often starting in childhood. It can affect how a person attaches, thinks about themselves, and manages emotions.

#41 · Assessment and Planning

What is the defense mechanism of denial?

Answer

Denial is refusing to accept a painful reality in order to avoid the feelings it brings. It can be temporary or long-lasting.

#42 · Assessment and Planning

What is the defense mechanism of projection?

Answer

Projection is putting one's own unacceptable feelings onto another person. For example, someone who is secretly angry accuses others of being angry.

#43 · Assessment and Planning

What is the biopsychosocial-spiritual assessment?

Answer

It gathers biological, psychological, social, and spiritual factors together. The social worker looks at health, emotions, relationships, culture, and beliefs to see the whole person.

#44 · Assessment and Planning

What is triangulation in a family?

Answer

Triangulation is when a third person gets pulled into a conflict between two people. A child may be caught in the middle of parents arguing.

#45 · Assessment and Planning

What is parentification?

Answer

Parentification is when a child is expected to care for a parent or siblings in an adult role too early. It can rob the child of their own childhood needs.

#46 · Assessment and Planning

What is enmeshment in a family?

Answer

Enmeshment is a family pattern where members are so close that personal boundaries blur. Acting independently can feel like disloyalty.

#47 · Assessment and Planning

What is a genogram?

Answer

A genogram is a family tree diagram that shows relationships, health, and patterns across generations. It helps the worker see how family history shapes the present.

#48 · Assessment and Planning

What is an ecomap?

Answer

An ecomap is a diagram of a person's ties to outside systems such as school, work, and community. Solid, broken, or stressed lines show the quality of each connection.

#49 · Assessment and Planning

What is a risk assessment?

Answer

A risk assessment collects information about danger to self or others, including thoughts, plans, means, and past behavior. It shapes a safety plan and treatment choices.

#50 · Assessment and Planning

What is a strengths-based assessment?

Answer

It focuses on what the client can do and what supports they already have, not only on problems. The worker builds on abilities, values, and resources.

#51 · Assessment and Planning

What is resilience?

Answer

Resilience is the ability to recover from stress, trauma, or loss. It grows from relationships, skills, and supports, not just from inner grit.

#52 · Assessment and Planning

What are the stages of change?

Answer

The stages are precontemplation, contemplation, preparation, action, and maintenance. People move through them as they prepare to change, and they can relapse and recycle.

#53 · Assessment and Planning

What is the spirit of motivational interviewing?

Answer

It is a collaborative, accepting style that draws out a person's own reasons for change. The worker avoids arguing and respects the client's freedom to choose.

#54 · Assessment and Planning

What does the mental status exam (MSE) cover?

Answer

The MSE covers appearance, behavior, speech, mood, affect, thought process, perception, cognition, insight, and judgment. Mood is the emotion the client reports, and affect is the emotion the worker sees in the moment.

#55 · Assessment and Planning

What are common side effects of SSRI antidepressants?

Answer

SSRIs are a common class of antidepressants and can cause nausea, sleep changes, sexual problems, and jitteriness when a person starts them. Many side effects fade, but the client should tell the prescriber and never stop suddenly.

#56 · Assessment and Planning

What is permanency in child welfare?

Answer

Permanency is a stable, safe, long-term home for a child, ideally with family. Plans can include reunification, adoption, or guardianship.

#57 · Assessment and Planning

What is caregiver burden?

Answer

Caregiver burden is the stress that comes from caring for a loved one who is ill or frail. It can cause exhaustion, depression, and health problems, so supporting the caregiver matters.

#58 · Intervention and Practice

What is empathy in the helping relationship?

Answer

Empathy means understanding and sharing a client's feelings from their point of view. It builds trust and shows the client they are truly heard.

#59 · Intervention and Practice

What is rapport in the helping relationship?

Answer

Rapport is the trusting, comfortable connection between social worker and client. It grows through warmth, consistency, and genuine listening.

#60 · Intervention and Practice

What is unconditional positive regard?

Answer

Unconditional positive regard means accepting a client as a person without judgment, even when you disagree with their behavior. It helps clients feel safe enough to be honest.

#61 · Intervention and Practice

What is strengths-based practice and empowerment?

Answer

Strengths-based practice builds on a client's abilities, resources, and supports instead of focusing only on problems. Empowerment is the goal of helping clients gain power over their own lives through skills, knowledge, and choices.

#62 · Intervention and Practice

What are the steps of problem solving?

Answer

Problem solving usually moves through defining the problem, brainstorming options, choosing one, making a plan, acting, and evaluating. The worker guides the client through each step.

#63 · Intervention and Practice

What is an interdisciplinary team?

Answer

An interdisciplinary team is a group of providers from different fields, such as social work, nursing, and medicine, who work together. Members share information and coordinate care for the whole person.

#64 · Intervention and Practice

What is the difference between palliative and hospice care?

Answer

Palliative care focuses on comfort and quality of life for anyone with a serious illness at any stage. Hospice is a type of palliative care for people near the end of life who stop curative treatment.

#65 · Intervention and Practice

What is parenting support in social work?

Answer

Parenting support helps caregivers build safe, warm, and consistent routines with children. Effective parenting balances structure, clear limits, and emotional responsiveness.

#66 · Intervention and Practice

What is trauma-informed care?

Answer

Trauma-informed care assumes that many clients have trauma histories and aims to avoid re-traumatizing them. It is guided by safety, trustworthiness, choice, collaboration, and empowerment.

#67 · Intervention and Practice

What is crisis intervention?

Answer

Crisis intervention is short-term help that reduces immediate danger and helps a person stabilize. It focuses on the present, on safety, and on a clear plan.

#68 · Intervention and Practice

What are CBT and DBT?

Answer

Cognitive behavioral therapy (CBT) works on how thoughts, feelings, and behaviors connect so clients can change unhelpful thinking. Dialectical behavior therapy (DBT) is a CBT-based approach that adds skills for emotion regulation, distress tolerance, and relationships.

#69 · Intervention and Practice

What is motivational interviewing?

Answer

Motivational interviewing is a client-centered style that draws out a person's own reasons to change. It uses open questions, reflection, and respect for the client's choice.

#70 · Intervention and Practice

What is EMDR?

Answer

EMDR stands for eye movement desensitization and reprocessing and uses guided eye movements to help the brain process traumatic memories. It can lower the distress linked to trauma.

#71 · Intervention and Practice

What are mindfulness and emotional regulation?

Answer

Mindfulness is paying full attention to the present moment without judgment. Emotional regulation is the skill of noticing and managing strong feelings so they do not take over.

#72 · Intervention and Practice

What are the stages of grief?

Answer

The stages of grief are often listed as denial, anger, bargaining, depression, and acceptance. They are not a fixed order, and people move back and forth between them.

#73 · Intervention and Practice

What is case management?

Answer

Case management organizes and coordinates services for a client across multiple systems. The worker links, plans, monitors, and advocates for the supports the client needs.

#74 · Intervention and Practice

What are the stages of a group?

Answer

Groups commonly move through forming, storming, norming, performing, and adjourning. Knowing the stage helps the worker guide the group and handle conflict.

#75 · Intervention and Practice

What are structural and Bowenian family therapy?

Answer

Structural family therapy looks at family rules, boundaries, and subsystems and works to reorganize them. Bowenian therapy sees the family as an emotional unit and highlights differentiation of self and triangles across generations.

#76 · Intervention and Practice

What is advocacy in social work?

Answer

Advocacy means speaking up and acting for a client or community to obtain rights and resources. It challenges the barriers that block access and fairness.

#77 · Intervention and Practice

What is conflict resolution?

Answer

Conflict resolution helps people in disagreement talk, listen, and find a workable solution. It often separates the person from the problem and focuses on shared interests.

#78 · Intervention and Practice

What are goal setting and partializing?

Answer

Goal setting turns a client's needs into clear, realistic, and measurable outcomes. Partializing means breaking a big problem or goal into smaller, manageable steps.

#79 · Intervention and Practice

What are discharge planning and aftercare?

Answer

Discharge planning prepares a client to leave a setting and continue safely in the community, with follow-up services and supports in place. Aftercare is that continued support after discharge, which reduces relapse and helps stability.

#80 · Intervention and Practice

What are the functions of supervision?

Answer

Supervision has three main functions: administrative, educational, and supportive. It monitors the work, builds the worker's skills, and provides emotional support.

#81 · Intervention and Practice

What is parallel process?

Answer

Parallel process is when what happens in the client-worker relationship shows up again in the worker-supervisor relationship. The worker may bring the same feelings or patterns to supervision without realizing it.

#82 · Intervention and Practice

What are transference and countertransference?

Answer

Transference is when a client projects feelings about important people in their life onto the worker. Countertransference is when the worker's own feelings and history get triggered by the client.

#83 · Intervention and Practice

What is the difference between formative and summative evaluation?

Answer

Formative evaluation happens during a program or treatment to guide adjustments along the way. Summative evaluation happens at the end to judge results and overall effectiveness.

#84 · Intervention and Practice

What is the difference between reliability and validity?

Answer

Reliability is how consistent a tool measures a thing across time and users. Validity is whether the tool actually measures what it is supposed to measure.

#85 · Values and Ethics

What is informed consent in social work?

Answer

Informed consent means a client agrees to services after you explain the purpose, risks, benefits, and alternatives. It must be given freely, and the client must have the capacity to understand and decide.

#86 · Values and Ethics

What does confidentiality mean for a social worker?

Answer

Confidentiality means you keep what a client shares private and only share it with people who need to know. You explain the limits of confidentiality, like danger or abuse, at the very start.

#87 · Values and Ethics

What is HIPAA and what does it protect?

Answer

HIPAA is a US law called the Health Insurance Portability and Accountability Act. It protects a person's private health information and limits who may see or share it.

#88 · Values and Ethics

When can a social worker share private client information without consent?

Answer

A social worker may share information without consent when the law requires it, such as suspected child abuse or a serious threat of harm. These legal openings are called the limits of confidentiality.

#89 · Values and Ethics

What does a mandatory reporter have to do?

Answer

A social worker is a mandatory reporter, so they must report suspected child abuse or neglect to the right authority. You only need a reasonable suspicion, not proof.

#90 · Values and Ethics

What is the duty to warn or the duty to protect?

Answer

When a client makes a serious, credible threat to harm someone, a social worker may have a duty to warn that person or protect others. You break confidentiality as needed to keep people safe.

#91 · Values and Ethics

Why are professional boundaries important in social work?

Answer

Boundaries keep the work focused on the client's needs and stop other roles like friend or family member from mixing in. They protect both the client and the social worker from harm.

#92 · Values and Ethics

What is the client's right to self-determination?

Answer

Self-determination means clients choose their own path and make their own decisions. The social worker helps them see options and outcomes, then respects what they decide.

#93 · Values and Ethics

What is the first step in resolving an ethical dilemma?

Answer

First, identify the dilemma clearly by naming the facts, the people involved, and the values in conflict. Then consult the code of ethics, consider each option, and seek supervision before acting.

#94 · Values and Ethics

What does the NASW core value service mean?

Answer

Service means the social worker's main goal is to help people in need and solve social problems. It puts the needs of the community above the professional's own interests.

#95 · Values and Ethics

What does the NASW core value social justice mean?

Answer

Social justice means social workers take action against conditions like poverty, discrimination, and unfair policies. They work toward fair access to resources for vulnerable groups.

#96 · Values and Ethics

What does the NASW value dignity and worth of the person mean?

Answer

It means every person has inherent worth and deserves respectful treatment. Social workers respect each client's dignity and honor their choices.

#97 · Values and Ethics

Why does NASW list human relationships as a core value?

Answer

Because the relationship is the main tool for change in social work. Social workers strengthen relationships between people and treat the client as a partner.

#98 · Values and Ethics

What does the NASW core value integrity mean in practice?

Answer

Integrity means a social worker acts honestly, responsibly, and ethically at all times. You avoid deception and practice within your own competence.

#99 · Values and Ethics

What does the NASW core value competence require?

Answer

Competence means a social worker practices only within their knowledge and skills and keeps learning. When a case is beyond them, they refer to someone more qualified.

#100 · Values and Ethics

What is privilege in social work?

Answer

Privilege is an unearned advantage that some people get from their identity, like race, class, gender, or ability. Having privilege means those barriers are easier for you, not that your life is easy.

#101 · Values and Ethics

What is implicit bias and why does it matter?

Answer

Implicit bias is a hidden attitude or belief you carry without knowing it. It can change how you treat clients, so you must notice and check it to give fair care.

#102 · Values and Ethics

What is a microaggression in social work?

Answer

A microaggression is a small, often offhand comment or act that demeans someone because of their group. Each one can seem minor, but constant slights cause real stress and harm.

#103 · Values and Ethics

What is anti-oppressive and anti-racist practice?

Answer

This practice names and challenges the structures that keep people down because of race, class, gender, or disability. The social worker helps the client and also works to change the unfair systems causing the problem.

#104 · Values and Ethics

What is cultural humility in practice?

Answer

Cultural humility is an ongoing practice of staying open and willing to learn about another person's culture. You follow the client's lead because the client is the expert on their own life.

#105 · Values and Ethics

What does accessibility mean in social work services?

Answer

Accessibility means services work for people with different abilities, languages, and resources. It includes physical access, interpreters, plain language, transportation, and low cost options.

#106 · Values and Ethics

What is environmental justice in social work?

Answer

Environmental justice means all people get fair protection from pollution and climate harm, especially poor and minority groups. Social workers link these harms to advocacy and systemic change.

#107 · Values and Ethics

What is financial exploitation of an older adult?

Answer

Financial exploitation is the illegal or improper use of an older adult's money, property, or assets. Signs include sudden bank changes, a new person controlling finances, and unpaid bills.

#108 · Values and Ethics

What is human trafficking in social work?

Answer

Human trafficking is recruiting or holding a person with force, fraud, or coercion to make them work or sell sex. Signs include being controlled, fearful, unable to leave, or having no papers.

#109 · Values and Ethics

What is the difference between an immigrant and a refugee?

Answer

An immigrant chooses to move to a new country for work, family, or other reasons. A refugee is forced to flee persecution based on race, religion, nationality, political opinion, or membership in a social group, and has specific legal protection needs. Displacement from a natural disaster alone does not confer refugee status.

#110 · Values and Ethics

What is restorative justice and how does it work?

Answer

Restorative justice works to repair the harm done instead of only punishing the person who caused it. It brings together the harmed person, the person responsible, and the community to make things right.

#111 · Values and Ethics

What is the difference between burnout and compassion fatigue?

Answer

Burnout is exhaustion from heavy workload, stress, and feeling ineffective, and it gets better with rest or a job change. Compassion fatigue and secondary trauma come from repeatedly absorbing a client's pain.

#112 · Values and Ethics

Why do self-care and professional development matter for a social worker?

Answer

Self-care keeps a social worker from burning out so they can keep helping others well. Professional development means ongoing learning, supervision, and growth so practice stays current and ethical.

#113 · Assessment and Planning

What does Erikson's theory of psychosocial development say?

Answer

Erikson said people grow through eight life stages, each with a crisis to resolve, like trust versus mistrust. Success at each stage builds a healthy identity, and failure can cause later problems.

#114 · Assessment and Planning

What does Piaget's theory describe?

Answer

Piaget described how children's thinking grows through stages, like sensorimotor, preoperational, concrete operational, and formal operational. Each stage means the child can understand the world in a more complex way.

#115 · Assessment and Planning

What does Kohlberg's theory explain?

Answer

Kohlberg explained moral reasoning in stages, moving from fear of punishment to following rules to using personal principles. A person moves through these stages at different rates.

#116 · Assessment and Planning

What are the main attachment styles in children?

Answer

Secure attachment means the child trusts the caregiver and feels safe exploring. Anxious and avoidant attachment can form when care is inconsistent or rejecting, and they show up as clingy or distant behavior.

#117 · Assessment and Planning

What is complex or intergenerational trauma?

Answer

Complex trauma is repeated harm over time, often by a caregiver, that affects how a person sees themselves and others. Intergenerational trauma is trauma passed down through families or whole communities across generations.

#118 · Assessment and Planning

What are some signs of child abuse or neglect?

Answer

Physical abuse signs include unusual bruises, burns, or injuries that do not match the story. Neglect shows as poor hygiene, hunger, untreated medical needs, or being left unsupervised, and emotional abuse shows as extreme fear or withdrawal.

#119 · Assessment and Planning

What is a biopsychosocial-spiritual assessment?

Answer

It is a full assessment that looks at the biological, psychological, social, and spiritual parts of a client's life. It gives a whole picture instead of focusing on only one problem.

#120 · Assessment and Planning

What does a good suicide risk assessment include?

Answer

You ask directly about suicidal thoughts, intent, plan, and means, plus past attempts and supports. You also weigh warning signs like hopelessness, isolation, and recent loss.

#121 · Assessment and Planning

What are strengths, resources, resilience, and coping?

Answer

Strengths are a client's own abilities and knowledge, and resources are outside supports like family, jobs, and services. Resilience is the ability to recover after hardship, and coping is how a person manages stress.

#122 · Assessment and Planning

What is motivational interviewing in practice?

Answer

Motivational interviewing is a conversation style that helps a client find their own reasons to change. It uses open questions, affirmation, reflection, and summarizing, and avoids arguing or pushing.

#123 · Assessment and Planning

What does a mental status exam assess?

Answer

The MSE checks appearance, mood and affect, speech, thought process and content, cognition, and insight and judgment. It is a snapshot of how a person is thinking and behaving at that moment.

#124 · Assessment and Planning

What is the defense mechanism of displacement?

Answer

Displacement is aiming an emotion at a safer person or object because the real target feels too risky. A worker who is frustrated with a supervisor may go home and snap at a family member.

#125 · Assessment and Planning

What is the defense mechanism of sublimation?

Answer

Sublimation turns an unacceptable urge into a socially accepted activity. Someone with strong anger might take up boxing or painting to express it safely.

#126 · Assessment and Planning

What is the defense mechanism of rationalization?

Answer

Rationalization is inventing a reasonable explanation for a behavior to hide the real reason. Someone who fails a test may blame a bad night of sleep rather than admit they did not study.

#127 · Assessment and Planning

What is parentification in a family?

Answer

Parentification is a child taking on adult responsibilities too early, like caring for siblings or a sick parent. It takes away childhood and can lead to stress and anger later.

#128 · Assessment and Planning

What is a genogram and how is it used?

Answer

A genogram is a family tree covering at least three generations with details about relationships and important events. It can reveal patterns like repeated conflict, divorce, or mental illness.

#129 · Assessment and Planning

What is an ecomap and what does it show?

Answer

An ecomap shows how a person or family connects to outside systems like work, school, and services. Solid lines show strong support, and broken lines show stress or a lack of connection.

#130 · Assessment and Planning

What is an SSRI and what is it used for?

Answer

An SSRI is a type of antidepressant that raises serotonin in the brain. It is used for depression and anxiety, and side effects can include nausea, sleep problems, and sexual side effects.

#131 · Assessment and Planning

What are antipsychotic medications used for?

Answer

Antipsychotics treat symptoms like hallucinations and delusions in conditions such as schizophrenia and bipolar disorder. They change how the brain uses dopamine and can have serious side effects.

#132 · Assessment and Planning

What are mood stabilizers used for?

Answer

Mood stabilizers, like lithium, help even out the highs and lows of bipolar disorder. They are taken every day and often need blood level checks to stay safe.

#133 · Assessment and Planning

What are benzodiazepines and stimulants used for?

Answer

Benzodiazepines are sedatives used short term for severe anxiety or panic, and they carry a risk of dependence. Stimulants, like those for ADHD, increase focus but can raise heart rate and cause insomnia.

#134 · Intervention and Practice

What are the core conditions of a helping relationship?

Answer

The core conditions that build a helping relationship are empathy, unconditional positive regard, and genuineness. These Carl Rogers conditions let the client feel understood and safe, which makes change more likely.

#135 • Intervention and Practice

What is a strengths-based and empowerment approach?

Answer

This approach starts with what the client can do and has, not with their deficits. The worker shares power and helps the client gain skills and confidence to act on their own behalf.

#136 • Intervention and Practice

What are the steps in a problem-solving process?

Answer

Common steps are to define the problem, brainstorm options, weigh the pros and cons, pick one, and try it. Then you evaluate the result and adjust if it does not work.

#137 · Intervention and Practice

What is the difference between palliative care and hospice?

Answer

Palliative care improves comfort and quality of life at any stage of a serious illness. Hospice is palliative care for people near the end of life, usually when they stop curative treatment.

#138 · Intervention and Practice

What does assessing parenting capacity cover?

Answer

You look at the parent's ability to protect, feed, and nurture the child and to provide a safe home. The goal is to judge if the child's basic needs are being met.

#139 · Intervention and Practice

What are the principles of trauma-informed care?

Answer

Key principles of trauma-informed care include safety, trustworthiness, choice, collaboration, and empowerment, along with peer support and attention to cultural, historical, and gender issues. The work also aims to avoid re-traumatizing the client in the helping process.

#140 · Intervention and Practice

What is the goal of crisis intervention?

Answer

Crisis intervention gives immediate, short term help to lower distress and keep a person safe. The worker stays calm, keeps the person in the present, and connects them to supports.

#141 • Intervention and Practice

What does cognitive behavioral therapy (CBT) focus on?

Answer

CBT works on the idea that thoughts, feelings, and behaviors are linked. The client learns to notice and change unhelpful thoughts to feel better and change behavior.

#142 • Intervention and Practice

What is dialectical behavior therapy (DBT) for?

Answer

DBT is a type of therapy built for strong emotions and self-harm. It teaches mindfulness, distress tolerance, emotion regulation, and interpersonal skills.

#143 · Intervention and Practice

What is EMDR and what is it used for?

Answer

EMDR is a therapy for trauma. The client holds a traumatic memory while moving their eyes back and forth, which helps reprocess the memory so it causes less distress.

#144 · Intervention and Practice

What is mindfulness and how does it help with emotions?

Answer

Mindfulness is paying attention to the present moment without judging it. It helps a person notice an emotion early and respond calmly instead of reacting.

#145 · Intervention and Practice

What are the Kubler-Ross stages of grief?

Answer

The stages are denial, anger, bargaining, depression, and acceptance. They are not a fixed order, and a person may move back and forth or skip stages.

#146 · Intervention and Practice

What is case management and what does it involve?

Answer

Case management is coordinating all the services a client needs into one plan. The worker links the client to resources, tracks progress, and advocates so nothing falls through the cracks.

#147 · Intervention and Practice

What are the stages of group development?

Answer

A common model is forming, storming, norming, performing, and adjourning. Groups start politely, then have conflict, then set rules, then work well, and finally end.

#148 · Intervention and Practice

What does structural family therapy look at?

Answer

Structural therapy looks at family boundaries, roles, and power and how they are organized. The worker helps the family reorganize so all members can get their needs met.

#149 · Intervention and Practice

What does Bowenian family therapy focus on?

Answer

Bowenian therapy looks at how family patterns pass between generations and how anxiety spreads in a system. It helps each person separate from family worry and define themselves.

#150 · Intervention and Practice

What is a good approach to conflict resolution?

Answer

Help each side say what they need, listen to the other, and find common ground. The goal is a fair, workable solution, not one side winning.

#151 · Intervention and Practice

What is macro social work practice?

Answer

Macro practice works on change at the community, agency, or policy level instead of with one person. It includes organizing, policy work, and programs that help many people.

#152 · Intervention and Practice

What does partializing a goal mean?

Answer

Partializing means breaking a big goal into smaller, doable steps. It makes the objective feel possible and gives the client wins along the way.

#153 • Intervention and Practice

What is discharge planning and wrap-around care?

Answer

Discharge planning arranges the services and supports a client needs when they leave a program. Wrap-around care coordinates the community team around the whole family so the client is not left alone.

#154 • Intervention and Practice

What are the functions of supervision and what is parallel process?

Answer

Supervision has three functions: administrative, which manages work and policy; educational, which builds skill; and supportive, which helps with stress. Parallel process is when how the client acts shows up in how the supervisee acts with the supervisor.

#155 · Intervention and Practice

What is the difference between experimental, quasi, and correlational research?

Answer

Experimental research randomizes who gets a treatment, so cause can be shown.
Quasi-experimental research uses groups without random assignment, so cause is weaker.
Correlational research only shows whether two things move together, not which causes which.

#156 · Values and Ethics

What is a boundary crossing in social work?

Answer

A boundary crossing is a small, short-term departure from a standard professional boundary that is not exploitative. It can be harmless or even helpful, but the worker must check it for risk. A boundary violation is different because it uses the relationship to exploit or harm the client.

#157 · Values and Ethics

What must be covered in informed consent?

Answer

Informed consent covers the purpose of services, the risks and benefits, the limits of confidentiality, and the right to refuse or stop. The worker also explains fees and the nature of the services. Consent must be given freely by a client who can understand the information.

#158 · Values and Ethics

A client cannot make their own treatment decisions. How is consent handled?

Answer

When a client lacks capacity, the worker seeks consent from a legal guardian or the person with authority to decide. The client still gets clear, simple information and is asked for agreement when possible. The worker uses the least restrictive option that respects the client's wishes.

#159 · Values and Ethics

When may confidentiality be broken to prevent self-harm?

Answer

Confidentiality may be broken when the client has a serious and imminent risk of harming themselves. The worker shares only the minimum information needed to keep the person safe. A vague worry does not justify disclosure, but an active and specific threat does.

#160 · Values and Ethics

What is a social worker's duty to warn?

Answer

The duty to warn requires the worker to protect a specific person who is under a serious and imminent threat from a client. This can mean warning the intended target or notifying law enforcement. The idea grew from a court case and is now part of many state laws.

#161 · Values and Ethics

A client tells you about child abuse. What must you do?

Answer

Social workers are mandated reporters and must report reasonable suspicion of child abuse or neglect to the right agency. The report is required even if the client asks you to keep it secret. You need reasonable suspicion, not proof.

#162 · Values and Ethics

How does reporting duty apply to older or dependent adults?

Answer

Most states require workers to report abuse, neglect, or exploitation of older and dependent adults. The report goes to Adult Protective Services or law enforcement. Because state rules differ, workers must know the law where they practice.

#163 · Values and Ethics

How is privileged communication different from confidentiality?

Answer

Confidentiality is an ethical duty to keep client information private. Privileged communication is a legal protection that keeps certain exchanges out of court. Privilege belongs to the client, so only the client can waive it.

#164 · Values and Ethics

When is client self-determination limited?

Answer

Self-determination is limited when a client is at serious risk of harming self or others, when they lack the capacity to decide, or when they ask for help with something illegal. The worker honors autonomy as far as safety and law allow. Any limit is explained to the client openly.

#165 · Values and Ethics

How does self-determination work with a minor client?

Answer

A minor's right to decide is balanced with the consent of a parent or guardian and with the minor's maturity. The worker asks the minor for agreement while also getting the guardian's permission. Safety and legal requirements come first.

#166 · Values and Ethics

What should a social worker discuss before providing telehealth?

Answer

Before telehealth, the worker gets informed consent about privacy risks of the platform, how to reach help in an emergency, and what to do if the connection fails. They use a secure, encrypted service and verify the client's identity and location. They also check whether they may practice where the client is.

#167 · Values and Ethics

How should a social worker respond to a client's social media friend request?

Answer

Accepting a friend request can blur the professional boundary and create risk. The worker declines politely and restates the boundary. Keeping personal accounts private and maintaining separate professional pages lowers the risk.

#168 · Values and Ethics

Who answers for a supervisee's clinical mistake?

Answer

The supervisor holds responsibility for overseeing practice and making sure the supervisee works within their ability. Even when the supervisee makes an error, the supervisor cannot deny all accountability. The supervisor is responsible for the quality of services in their unit.

#169 · Values and Ethics

What does competent supervision include?

Answer

Competent supervision includes regular meetings, a clear agreement on roles and duties, and training in ethics and cultural humility. The supervisor gives honest feedback and watches for burnout or impairment. They also keep developing their own clinical and supervisory skills.

#170 · Values and Ethics

How should a worker document and bill for services?

Answer

Records must describe the service actually provided, and billing must match with honest dates and codes. A worker must not bill for sessions that did not happen or inflate the length of a session. Fees are explained and agreed to up front.

#171 · Values and Ethics

What should a social worker do after making a mistake?

Answer

The worker acknowledges the error honestly, corrects it where possible, and tells the client the truth if harm occurred. They document what happened and seek supervision, consultation, or an ethics review. Hiding a mistake is itself a serious breach.

#172 · Values and Ethics

What is an ethics consultation?

Answer

An ethics consultation is help from a neutral third party, such as an ethics committee or a seasoned colleague, to work through a hard ethical question. It gives an organized way to look at duties, standards, and choices. It helps when a problem is complex, high stakes, or unclear.

#173 · Values and Ethics

A client needs help you are not trained to give. What do you do?

Answer

The worker should refer the client to someone with the right expertise, or get more training and consultation first. Working outside your training or experience can cause harm and is unethical. The client's need matters more than keeping the case.

#174 · Values and Ethics

You suspect a colleague is impaired at work. What do you do?

Answer

The worker should raise the concern privately with the colleague and then report to a supervisor or ethics body if needed. The goal is to protect clients while helping the colleague get support. Doing nothing when a client is at risk is itself a problem.

#175 · Values and Ethics

What is a conflict of interest in social work?

Answer

A conflict of interest happens when a worker's personal, financial, or organizational interest could cloud their judgment. The worker reveals the conflict, avoids it when possible, and gets informed consent if it cannot be avoided. It is a boundary issue that needs careful handling.

#176 · Values and Ethics

What does cultural humility mean in practice?

Answer

Cultural humility is an ongoing practice of self-reflection and of reducing power gaps between the worker and people of different backgrounds. The worker stays curious about the client's culture instead of assuming they already understand it. The client stays the expert on their own identity and experience.

#177 · Values and Ethics

What does the social justice value require from a worker?

Answer

Social justice is the commitment to challenge problems such as poverty, discrimination, and unfair access to resources. Workers push for policies and systems that protect the rights of marginalized people. They balance a client's immediate needs with larger structural change.

#178 · Values and Ethics

What does the ethical principle nonmaleficence mean?

Answer

Nonmaleficence is the duty to avoid causing harm to clients. The worker must not act in ways that hurt a client through incompetence, exploitation, or broken trust. When harm is possible, the worker picks the safest, least harmful route.

#179 · Values and Ethics

What does the ethical principle beneficence require?

Answer

Beneficence is the duty to actively promote the client's welfare, not merely to avoid harm. The worker gives competent, helpful service in the client's best interest. It is weighed against the client's right to decide for themselves.

#180 · Values and Ethics

What is fidelity in practice?

Answer

Fidelity is the duty to be honest, keep promises, and honor the commitments made to clients. It includes staying loyal to the trust of the relationship and following through on agreements. It is the basis of informed consent and confidentiality.

#181 · Values and Ethics

How is a client's best interest weighed against self-determination?

Answer

When a client's choice could bring serious harm, the worker weighs best interest against self-determination. The worker looks for the option that protects the client while honoring choice as much as possible. In a true conflict, safety can take priority, and the reason is explained to the client.

#182 · Values and Ethics

When confidentiality is broken, how much should you share?

Answer

The worker must disclose only the minimum information required to meet the legal or safety need. This is the least restrictive approach that still protects the person. Sharing more than necessary without cause is an ethical breach.

#183 · Values and Ethics

Can a client stop services at any time?

Answer

A client has the right to withdraw consent and to end services at any time without pressure or punishment. The worker explains this right up front and responds to a request to stop with a respectful review of options. If the client leaves, the worker provides a safe referral or transfer.

#184 · Values and Ethics

What is informed consent for releasing client information?

Answer

A release of information is valid when the client, or a legally authorized representative, signs and dates it after understanding what is shared, who receives it, why, and for how long. The client's signature authorizes the disclosure, and a new release is needed when the authorization runs out. Sharing without valid consent is a breach.

#185 · Assessment and Planning

What does a biopsychosocial assessment cover?

Answer

It gathers information across the biological, psychological, social, and spiritual parts of a person's life. The worker looks at health, mental health, relationships, housing, work, and culture. It shapes a full understanding of the client so the plan fits the whole person.

#186 · Assessment and Planning

When should a worker use open instead of closed questions?

Answer

Open questions invite the client to describe in their own words and are useful early in an interview. Closed questions ask for a short, specific answer and are useful to confirm details. The worker blends them to get full information without making the client feel interrogated.

#187 · Assessment and Planning

What is collateral information in an assessment?

Answer

Collateral information is data gathered from people or records around the client, such as family, a doctor, or old treatment records. It helps verify what the client said and can fill in gaps. The client should generally give consent before the worker contacts others.

#188 · Assessment and Planning

What domains does a mental status exam cover?

Answer

The mental status exam describes how the client looks and thinks in the moment. It covers appearance and behavior, speech, mood and affect, thought process and content, cognition, insight, and judgment. It adds a clinical snapshot to the interview.

#189 · Assessment and Planning

In the mental status exam, what is the difference between mood and affect?

Answer

Mood is the client's own description of how they feel over time, such as depressed or anxious. Affect is the outward expression the worker observes in the session, such as flat, blunted, or labile. Mood is what the client reports, and affect is what you see.

#190 · Assessment and Planning

What is the difference between thought content and thought process?

Answer

Thought content is what the client is thinking about, such as delusions, obsessions, or suicidal ideas. Thought process is how the thoughts connect and flow, such as a logical, tangential, or disorganized style. Content is the subject, and process is the route.

#191 · Assessment and Planning

What do insight and judgment mean in a mental status exam?

Answer

Insight is the client's awareness that they have a problem and that they may need help. Judgment is the ability to make sound decisions and to understand the consequences of actions. Poor insight or judgment raises the level of concern for safety.

#192 · Assessment and Planning

What should a social worker ask when screening for suicide risk?

Answer

The worker asks directly about suicidal thoughts, plans, means, intent, and past attempts. They also ask about protective factors such as supports and reasons to live. Asking directly does not plant the idea and is a required part of a full risk assessment.

#193 · Assessment and Planning

How is risk of harming another person assessed?

Answer

The worker asks about thoughts of harming others, a specific target, a plan, and access to means. They also ask about past violence, substance use, and threats that are current and specific. A serious, imminent, and specific threat triggers the duty to protect.

#194 · Assessment and Planning

What is the difference between risk factors and protective factors?

Answer

Risk factors are things that raise the chance of harm, such as isolation, substance use, or past attempts. Protective factors lower that chance, such as a support network, engagement in treatment, and reasons to live. The worker weighs both sides to judge the level of risk.

#195 · Assessment and Planning

What is a safety plan?

Answer

A safety plan is a written, step-by-step plan the client uses when a crisis starts. It lists warning signs, coping strategies, people to contact, and emergency numbers. It is made with the client and made easy to follow.

#196 · Assessment and Planning

What is a genogram and what is it for?

Answer

A genogram is a family tree that shows relationships, health, and patterns across at least three generations. Workers use it to spot repeating patterns such as conflict, addiction, or estrangement. It helps the assessment go beyond the person to the family system.

#197 · Assessment and Planning

What is an ecomap used for in assessment?

Answer

An ecomap is a diagram of the client's links to outside people and systems, such as family, work, school, health care, and social services. Strong, weak, or stressful connections are drawn differently to show the quality of each link. It shows where support and strain sit in the client's environment.

#198 · Assessment and Planning

How can culture change how distress is expressed?

Answer

Culture shapes whether distress appears as emotional, physical, or spiritual symptoms and which symptoms a person feels safe to report. A worker who ignores culture may misread a normal expression as pathology or miss a real issue. The worker asks how the client understands their own problem and what they want from help.

#199 · Assessment and Planning

What should a worker consider when assessing across a language barrier?

Answer

The worker should use a trained interpreter rather than a family member when possible, and explain the interpreter's role to the client. They check that the assessment tool is valid for the client's language and culture. Gathering the client's own story in their own words is central to a fair assessment.

#200 · Assessment and Planning

Why is assessing readiness for change important?

Answer

Readiness tells the worker what kind of help is a fit for the client right now. Pushing for action too early can create resistance or drop out. The worker matches the approach to the stage, such as raising awareness first and skill building later.

#201 · Assessment and Planning

What is a crisis assessment?

Answer

A crisis assessment looks at an immediate threat and the client's ability to cope with it right now. The worker checks for danger to self or others, access to means, support, and what the client has already tried. The goal is to judge urgency and decide the quickest safe response.

#202 · Assessment and Planning

What is the ABC model of crisis intervention?

Answer

The ABC model has three steps: build rapport, identify the problem, and then cope. The worker first connects with the client, then names the problem and the feelings, then helps the client take action. The focus is short and on the here and now.

#203 · Assessment and Planning

What is a trauma-informed assessment?

Answer

A trauma-informed assessment asks about history of trauma, is aware of triggers, and aims to avoid re-traumatizing the client. The worker explains the process, offers choice, and watches for signs of distress. Safety and trust are treated as part of the assessment itself.

#204 · Assessment and Planning

Why are standardized screening tools used?

Answer

Standardized tools give a consistent way to measure symptoms and track change over time. They are most useful when they are reliable and valid for the client's population and language. A score is a guide and is always used with the clinical interview.

#205 · Assessment and Planning

What is the difference between a presenting problem and an underlying problem?

Answer

The presenting problem is the reason the client asks for help, such as anxiety at work. The underlying problem is the deeper cause, such as trauma, a health issue, or a lack of support. The worker addresses the surface need while looking for the root cause.

#206 · Assessment and Planning

Why is differential assessment important?

Answer

Differential assessment means ruling out other explanations for a client's symptoms before settling on a diagnosis. For example, a worker checks whether a medical condition, a drug, or side effects are causing the symptoms. It prevents a wrong label and gets the client the right help.

#207 · Assessment and Planning

Why assess a client's social support and environment?

Answer

A client's supports, housing, work, and safety strongly shape how well they do and whether a plan will work. The worker maps who can help, what resources exist, and what barriers are in the way. The plan is more realistic when it uses the client's real environment.

#208 · Assessment and Planning

What are ADLs and IADLs?

Answer

Activities of daily living are the basics such as bathing, dressing, eating, and getting around. Instrumental activities of daily living are the higher tasks such as managing money, using the phone, preparing meals, and taking medicine. Asking about them shows how independent a client is in day-to-day life.

#209 · Assessment and Planning

What makes a treatment goal a SMART goal?

Answer

A SMART goal is specific, measurable, achievable, relevant, and time-bound. It names who does what, how it will be measured, and by when. Clear goals let the worker and the client track progress and show whether the plan is working.

#210 · Intervention and Practice

What are the skills of active listening in practice?

Answer

Active listening means giving full attention and showing it through eye contact, open body language, and small prompts. The worker reflects what they heard so the client feels understood. It builds trust and gathers accurate information.

#211 · Intervention and Practice

How are paraphrasing and summarizing different?

Answer

Paraphrasing restates what the client just said in the worker's own words, usually in a few sentences. Summarizing pulls together larger pieces of a session or brings the focus back to the key theme. Both show the client that the worker is following and help organize the work.

#212 · Intervention and Practice

What is the difference between reflecting feeling and reflecting content?

Answer

Reflecting content repeats the facts and meaning of what the client said. Reflecting feeling names the emotion behind the words, such as sadness, anger, or fear. Reflecting feeling helps the client feel understood at a deeper level.

#213 · Intervention and Practice

How is empathy different from sympathy?

Answer

Empathy is the ability to understand and share the client's experience while staying separate enough to help. Sympathy is feeling sorry for the client, which can be less helpful. Empathy builds a working alliance, while too much sympathy can make the client feel pitied.

#214 · Intervention and Practice

What is limit setting in practice?

Answer

Limit setting is calmly and clearly stating a rule or boundary when a client's behavior becomes unsafe or disruptive, such as threats in a group. The worker names the limit, the reason, and the result, then offers an acceptable choice. It protects the client, others, and the worker without being punishing.

#215 • Intervention and Practice

What is psychoeducation and why is it used?

Answer

Psychoeducation means teaching the client facts about their condition, the treatment, and ways to manage symptoms. It gives the client understanding and skills so they can take part in their own care. Good education is clear, practical, and matched to the client's level.

#216 • Intervention and Practice

What is evidence-based practice in social work?

Answer

Evidence-based practice means choosing intervention methods supported by the best available research. The worker then adds their clinical judgment and the client's values and preferences to the decision. The three parts work together, so the evidence is never used without the client's voice.

#217 · Intervention and Practice

How are case advocacy and cause advocacy different?

Answer

Case advocacy means acting on behalf of one client or family to get a needed service or right. Cause advocacy works to change a policy or system that affects many people in the same situation. Case work is individual, and cause work is structural.

#218 · Intervention and Practice

What is an empowerment approach?

Answer

An empowerment approach helps clients build on their strengths, gain information, and take a lead role in solving their own problems. The worker shares power, teaches skills, and supports the client's choices. The aim is that the client becomes more able to act for themselves.

#219 · Intervention and Practice

What are the basic steps of conflict resolution?

Answer

Conflict resolution usually means naming the conflict, hearing each side without interruption, and finding the interests behind each position. The parties then look for shared ground and agree on a solution or next step. The worker stays neutral and keeps the focus on problems, not on blaming people.

#220 · Intervention and Practice

What are de-escalation techniques in practice?

Answer

De-escalation techniques lower the intensity of an angry or escalating person, such as a calm tone, moving slowly, and giving the person space and time. The worker focuses on one issue, avoids threats and loaded words, and offers choices. The goal is dialogue and safety, not a show of power.

#221 · Intervention and Practice

What is mediation in a conflict?

Answer

Mediation is a structured process where a neutral third person helps two or more people reach their own agreement. The mediator guides the talk but does not decide the outcome. It works best when both sides take an active part in building a solution.

#222 · Intervention and Practice

What are I and you statements in communication?

Answer

An I statement describes a person's own feeling and need, such as I feel worried when plans change at the last minute. A you statement blames the other person and tends to raise defensiveness, such as you are unreliable. I statements lower conflict and open the door to problem solving.

#223 · Intervention and Practice

What are group norms and cohesion?

Answer

Norms are the unwritten rules a group develops about acceptable behavior. Cohesion is the feeling of trust and belonging that holds members together. Cohesion helps members open up, and the worker builds it through a safe and structured environment.

#224 · Intervention and Practice

What is a structural family intervention?

Answer

Structural family therapy works on the organization of the family, such as who holds power and where the boundaries sit. The worker might join the family, map its patterns, and help realign roles such as parents acting as leaders. The goal is a healthier structure so the family works better.

#225 · Intervention and Practice

What is reframing in family work?

Answer

Reframing offers a new, more useful meaning for a behavior that the family sees as the problem. For example, a teenager's acting out is reframed as a bid for attention or worry in the family. This shifts blame and opens room for a different response.

#226 · Intervention and Practice

What is reinforcement in behavioral work?

Answer

Positive reinforcement adds something pleasant after a behavior to make it more likely to happen again, such as praise. Negative reinforcement removes something unpleasant, which also increases a behavior. Reinforcement strengthens target behaviors, while decreasing unwanted behavior is the role of punishment or extinction.

#227 · Intervention and Practice

What is cognitive-behavioral therapy based on?

Answer

Cognitive-behavioral therapy says that thoughts, feelings, and behaviors are linked. When a person changes a distorted thought, the feeling and the behavior tend to change too. It is a practical, present-focused approach that teaches skills the client can use on their own.

#228 · Intervention and Practice

What are the steps of a problem-solving approach?

Answer

The steps are to define the problem, brainstorm options, weigh the good and bad of each, and pick one to try. Then the client acts and later reviews how the choice worked. This builds a skill that lasts past the session.

#229 · Intervention and Practice

What is the miracle question used for?

Answer

The miracle question asks the client what their life would look like if the problem were solved overnight. The answer describes the client's own goals and the first small signs that things are better. It is a solution-focused tool that moves attention from problems to a workable goal.

#230 · Intervention and Practice

What does rolling with resistance mean in motivational interviewing?

Answer

Rolling with resistance accepts that a client may not want to change and avoids arguing when they push back. The worker reflects the resistance and explores the client's own reasons, instead of fighting it. This keeps the relationship strong and lets the client weigh their own motivation.

#231 • Intervention and Practice

How should a social worker handle planned termination?

Answer

Planned termination starts early and reviews the work done, progress made, and skills the client now has. The worker names the feelings that can come up and arranges follow-up from allies or a new provider. Ending well helps the change hold after the services stop.

#232 • Intervention and Practice

A client stops coming to sessions. How should a worker respond?

Answer

The worker reaches out to see what happened, invites the client back, and handles any lost sessions without shame. They ask about barriers such as cost, scheduling, or a poor fit and help remove them. The goal is to keep the door open and find the service the client can use.

#233 · Intervention and Practice

What is the purpose of clinical documentation?

Answer

Documentation keeps a clear record of the services provided, the client's progress, and the reasons for decisions. It supports continuity of care, billing, and quality review, and it can protect the worker in a legal or ethical dispute. A good note lets another provider understand the case quickly.

#234 · Intervention and Practice

What should a record include and what should it avoid?

Answer

A record should include the facts of the session, the client's statements, the worker's observations, the plan, and any safety concerns. It should avoid labels, guesses, and personal opinions about the client. Keeping to facts keeps the note accurate, useful, and defensible.

#235 · Intervention and Practice

What is discharge and transition planning?

Answer

Discharge planning prepares the client for the move out of services by reviewing progress and setting up what comes next. The worker coordinates with other providers and links the client to community resources they will need. A smooth transition lowers the chance of a relapse or a gap in care.

#236 · Values and Ethics

What is informed consent in social work practice?

Answer

Informed consent means the client agrees to services after hearing clear facts about the work, the limits, and the risks. The worker gets it freely and in language the client understands, before starting any service.

#237 · Values and Ethics

What does client self-determination mean?

Answer

Self-determination is the client's right to make their own choices about treatment and life. The worker supports that choice even when the client decides something the worker disagrees with.

#238 · Values and Ethics

What is confidentiality in social work?

Answer

Confidentiality means the worker keeps what a client shares private. It has limits, such as when someone may be hurt or a court orders release of the records.

#239 · Values and Ethics

What is a dual relationship in social work?

Answer

A dual relationship happens when the worker fills two roles with the same person, such as therapist and friend. It can blur judgment and harm the client, so it is avoided unless it is truly unavoidable.

#240 · Values and Ethics

What does professional competence mean?

Answer

Competence means practicing only inside the skills and knowledge you have. The worker keeps learning and gets training before taking on new kinds of work.

#241 · Values and Ethics

What does dignity and worth of the person mean?

Answer

It means every client is valued and respected as a person in their own right. The worker treats people with care and honors their strengths and choices.

#242 · Values and Ethics

What is the NASW core value of service?

Answer

Service means putting the act of helping clients and the community first. The worker brings professional skill to others before thinking of personal gain.

#243 · Values and Ethics

What is the NASW core value of social justice?

Answer

Social justice means working to change unfair systems that harm people, such as poverty and discrimination. The worker advocates for policies that give everyone a real chance.

#244 · Values and Ethics

What is the NASW core value of integrity?

Answer

Integrity means acting honestly and responsibly in professional work. The worker keeps promises and follows the Code of Ethics.

#245 · Values and Ethics

What is the NASW core value of human relationships?

Answer

This value says the bond between people is the main engine of change. The worker builds and uses relationships as the path to helping.

#246 · Values and Ethics

What is mandated reporting in social work?

Answer

Mandated reporting is a legal duty to tell officials about suspected child abuse or neglect. The worker reports on reasonable suspicion, not on proof.

#247 · Values and Ethics

What is the duty to protect, also called Tarasoff?

Answer

The duty to protect means the worker must act when a client makes a serious threat to harm another person. The worker may warn the target, alert police, or arrange a safer setting.

#248 · Values and Ethics

What is a professional boundary in practice?

Answer

A boundary is the line that keeps the helping relationship safe and focused on the client. Keeping it intact protects the client's trust and the worker's judgment.

#249 · Values and Ethics

What is privileged communication in practice?

Answer

Privileged communication shields certain client talks from being forced into court. It belongs to the client, who may choose to give it up.

#250 · Values and Ethics

What is cultural competence in social work?

Answer

Cultural competence means understanding and respecting a client's culture, identity, and background. The worker adapts the work to fit that culture rather than judging it.

#251 · Values and Ethics

What is a conflict of interest?

Answer

A conflict of interest arises when the worker's own money, needs, or ties could bias the work. The worker names it and gets help to keep the client's interests first.

#252 · Values and Ethics

What rule guides a social worker's self-disclosure?

Answer

Self-disclosure of personal details is allowed only when it clearly helps the client. Sharing too much puts the focus back on the worker instead of the client.

#253 · Values and Ethics

What is the ethical rule about gifts from clients?

Answer

The worker avoids gifts that could feel like payment or create a conflict. A small, culturally expected gift may be accepted when refusing would harm the relationship.

#254 · Values and Ethics

What is a social worker's record-keeping responsibility?

Answer

The worker keeps records that are accurate, timely, and secure. Records protect the client and stand as the official account of the service.

#255 · Values and Ethics

What is the right to privacy in the helping relationship?

Answer

Privacy means the client controls who sees their personal information. The worker collects only what is needed and shares it only with permission.

#256 · Values and Ethics

What is the difference between values, ethics, and laws?

Answer

Values are beliefs, ethics are professional rules of conduct, and laws are binding rules from government. The worker follows both the Code of Ethics and the law.

#257 · Values and Ethics

What is the ethical rule on intimate relationships with clients?

Answer

The worker never has an intimate relationship with a current client. NASW prohibits sexual activity or contact with former clients, and the worker bears the full burden of proving no exploitation in any claimed extraordinary exception.

#258 · Values and Ethics

How is informed consent handled with minors?

Answer

A parent or guardian usually consents before services start with a minor. The worker also seeks the young person's own agreement and weighs their ability to decide.

#259 · Values and Ethics

**A client says they plan to harm someone.
What is your first duty?**

Answer

Your first duty is to protect the person who may be harmed. That means warning the target where possible, alerting police, and documenting every step, even though it breaks confidentiality.

#260 · Values and Ethics

What is nonmaleficence in social work practice?

Answer

Nonmaleficence means acting to avoid harm. When a choice carries risk, the worker picks the path that protects the client most.

#261 · Values and Ethics

What is client abandonment, and how is it avoided?

Answer

Abandonment is stopping help while a client still needs it, without a plan. The worker avoids it by giving notice, closing well, and arranging a good transfer.

#262 · Values and Ethics

What does competent practice look like with telehealth?

Answer

The worker knows the technology and confirms it protects the client's privacy. Telehealth is used only when it serves the client and fits state rules.

#263 · Values and Ethics

Your supervisor asks you to release records without consent. What do you do?

Answer

You should not release private records without a lawful reason or client consent. Raise the concern with the supervisor and check the Code of Ethics and the law.

#264 · Values and Ethics

What do you do when a colleague is impaired or unethical?

Answer

First you protect the client from any risk. Then you address the issue directly with the colleague and, if needed, report it to the proper authority.

#265 · Values and Ethics

What does it mean to practice without discrimination?

Answer

The worker serves clients of every race, gender, age, religion, and orientation. The worker also works to end the unfair conditions that fuel bias.

#266 · Assessment and Planning

What is a biopsychosocial assessment used for?

Answer

It gathers information about the client's body, mind, and social world. The result shows health, emotions, family, work, and supports so the worker can see the whole person.

#267 · Assessment and Planning

What does a mental status exam (MSE) cover?

Answer

The MSE is a snapshot of how the client is acting while you talk. It covers appearance, mood, speech, and thinking at that moment.

#268 · Assessment and Planning

What is the purpose of a treatment plan?

Answer

A treatment plan lays out the goals, steps, and responsibilities of the work. It gives a clear path and a way to check whether the client is improving.

#269 · Assessment and Planning

What does the SMART goal format mean?

Answer

SMART stands for specific, measurable, achievable, relevant, and time-bound. Goals written this way are easy to track and review.

#270 · Assessment and Planning

What does a strengths-based assessment do?

Answer

It studies the client's abilities, skills, and supports rather than only the problems. The plan then builds on what the person already does well.

#271 · Assessment and Planning

What is a genogram in family assessment?

Answer

A genogram is a family tree that maps relationships and patterns across generations. It shows who is close, who fights, and what events repeat.

#272 · Assessment and Planning

What does an ecomap show about a client?

Answer

An ecomap pictures the client's links to outside groups such as school, work, and faith. It shows which ties are strong, weak, or stressful.

#273 · Assessment and Planning

What is a suicide risk assessment?

Answer

It asks directly about suicidal thoughts, plans, and means. The worker weighs the risk, then builds a safety plan and connects the client to support.

#274 · Assessment and Planning

What is the difference between diagnosis and assessment?

Answer

An assessment is the full picture of the client and their life. A diagnosis is a named condition taken from the DSM.

#275 · Assessment and Planning

What does reliability mean in a tool?

Answer

Reliability means the tool gives steady results each time it is used. A reliable measure checks the same thing in the same way.

#276 · Assessment and Planning

What does validity mean in a tool?

Answer

Validity means the tool measures what it is claimed to measure. A valid test truly captures the thing it was built to capture.

#277 · Assessment and Planning

What is the ecological systems perspective?

Answer

It sees the client inside layers such as family, school, and community. Change means working on people, settings, and the links between them.

#278 · Assessment and Planning

What is the difference between clinical and actuarial judgment?

Answer

Clinical judgment is the trained opinion of a worker. Actuarial judgment uses numbers and statistics to predict, and it tends to be more accurate for some decisions.

#279 · Assessment and Planning

What is a baseline in assessment?

Answer

A baseline is the starting level of a symptom or behavior before treatment. Later results are compared to it to judge if the work helped.

#280 · Assessment and Planning

What is the person-in-environment perspective?

Answer

It holds that a person's behavior cannot be separated from the setting they live in. The worker assesses both the person and their context.

#281 · Assessment and Planning

What is ongoing or formative assessment?

Answer

Formative assessment gathers information all through the work to guide it. It shows what is helping so the worker can adjust course.

#282 · Assessment and Planning

What does a readiness to change measure?

Answer

Readiness shows how willing and able a client is to change right now. It tells the worker which intervention fits the moment.

#283 · Assessment and Planning

What does a differential diagnosis do?

Answer

It compares possible conditions to find the one that best fits the symptoms. The worker rules out other explanations along the way.

#284 · Assessment and Planning

What does a developmental history capture?

Answer

It records the milestones and big events of a person's early years. It helps the worker see patterns in growth and attachment.

#285 · Assessment and Planning

What does a functional assessment examine?

Answer

It looks at how the client handles daily tasks like eating, dressing, and working. Gaps in these areas show what support the client needs.

#286 · Assessment and Planning

What does a social history include?

Answer

A social history holds the client's life story, work, education, and key relationships. It gives the context that shapes both assessment and plan.

#287 · Assessment and Planning

What is the difference between objective and subjective data?

Answer

Objective data can be seen or measured, such as restlessness or a test score. Subjective data is what the client reports, such as feeling worthless.

#288 · Assessment and Planning

What is the purpose of a screening tool?

Answer

A screening tool quickly flags possible signs, such as depression or trauma. A positive screen leads into a fuller assessment.

#289 · Assessment and Planning

What is the difference between assessment and evaluation?

Answer

Assessment gathers facts to understand and plan. Evaluation judges whether the service or program actually worked.

#290 · Assessment and Planning

What happens during an initial intake assessment?

Answer

The intake gathers basic facts and screens for immediate risk and needs. It decides whether this service fits and where the client should be referred.

#291 · Intervention and Practice

What is cognitive-behavioral therapy (CBT)?

Answer

CBT connects a person's thoughts, feelings, and actions. The client learns to spot unhelpful thoughts and change them so feelings and behavior follow.

#292 · Intervention and Practice

What is motivational interviewing used for?

Answer

It is a guiding style that finds the client's own reason to change. Instead of arguing, the worker listens and reflects to build the client's motivation.

#293 · Intervention and Practice

What does OARS stand for in practice?

Answer

OARS stands for open questions, affirmations, reflections, and summaries. These four skills move a client toward change without pressure.

#294 · Intervention and Practice

What is a therapeutic alliance in social work?

Answer

The alliance is the trusting bond between worker and client. It is one of the strongest signs of a good outcome.

#295 · Intervention and Practice

What is transference in therapy?

Answer

Transference happens when a client copies old feelings from an earlier relationship onto the worker. These reactions can reveal patterns from the client's past.

#296 · Intervention and Practice

What is countertransference in therapy?

Answer

Countertransference is the worker's own emotional response to the client. The worker notices it and keeps it from harming the work.

#297 · Intervention and Practice

What is solution-focused brief therapy?

Answer

It builds on the client's successes and hopes rather than the problem. The worker asks what is working and what would be different once the problem is gone.

#298 · Intervention and Practice

What is the engagement phase of the helping process?

Answer

Engagement is the opening phase where trust and a working bond are formed. A strong start here sets up everything that follows.

#299 · Intervention and Practice

What happens in the termination phase?

Answer

Termination closes the work in a planned way. The client reviews gains, processes feelings about leaving, and gets a clear follow-up plan.

#300 · Intervention and Practice

What is a defense mechanism in social work?

Answer

A defense mechanism is an automatic way the mind shields a person from hard feelings. Denial, projection, and rationalization are common examples.

#301 • Intervention and Practice

What does a case manager do?

Answer

A case manager coordinates services and connects the client to needed resources. They plan, refer, follow up, and advocate across systems.

#302 • Intervention and Practice

What is the broker role in case management?

Answer

The broker links the client to community services and programs. It is a referral role aimed at filling a concrete need.

#303 · Intervention and Practice

What are the usual phases of group development?

Answer

Groups usually move through forming, storming, norming, performing, and adjourning. In the storming phase members test roles and may clash, and adjourning is the final stage of closure.

#304 · Intervention and Practice

What does evidence-based practice combine?

Answer

Evidence-based practice blends the best research, the worker's skill, and the client's values. The worker chooses methods shown to work for that issue.

#305 • Intervention and Practice

What is the focus of a psychoeducational group?

Answer

It teaches members facts and skills about a shared concern. The goal is learning rather than deep personal change.

#306 • Intervention and Practice

Why is self-care important for a social worker?

Answer

Self-care protects the worker's own wellbeing so the demands of the job do not take over. It prevents burnout and keeps the worker able to help others.

#307 · Intervention and Practice

What is a behavioral intervention plan?

Answer

It identifies what triggers a behavior and how to respond the same way each time. The worker tracks patterns and sets rewards or steps to reduce problem behavior.

#308 · Intervention and Practice

What is change talk in motivational interviewing?

Answer

Change talk is when the client speaks in favor of making a change. The worker listens for it and uses reflection to build commitment.

#309 · Intervention and Practice

What is supervision in social work?

Answer

Supervision is a more experienced worker guiding another worker's practice. It builds skills, checks quality, and gives support.

#310 · Intervention and Practice

What does the empowerment approach do?

Answer

It helps clients gain skills, confidence, and control over their lives. The worker shares knowledge and backs the client's own decisions.

#311 · Intervention and Practice

What is the function of a referral?

Answer

A referral sends a client to another service that fits a need the worker cannot meet. A strong referral includes a warm link and a follow-up check.

#312 · Values and Ethics

What is client self-determination in social work?

Answer

Self-determination is the client's right to make their own decisions about their life and treatment. The social worker supports informed choices and only steps in when the client is at serious risk of harming self or others. It is the client's life and the client's call.

#313 · Values and Ethics

What are the main parts of informed consent?

Answer

Informed consent means the client agrees to services after understanding them. The social worker explains the nature of services, risks and benefits, alternatives, limits of confidentiality, and the right to refuse. Consent must be given freely in language the client understands.

#314 · Values and Ethics

When can a social worker break confidentiality?

Answer

Confidentiality protects what a client shares, but it has limits. A worker must break it to prevent serious and imminent harm to a person, to report suspected abuse, or when a court orders disclosure. These limits should be explained to the client up front.

#315 · Values and Ethics

What is the difference between privacy and confidentiality?

Answer

Privacy is a person's right to control access to their own information and body. Confidentiality is the ethical and legal duty of the professional to keep shared information protected. Social workers honor both and must know their legal duties.

#316 · Values and Ethics

Define dual or multiple relationships.

Answer

A dual relationship happens when a worker has a second role with a client, such as friend, business partner, or romantic partner. Some are harmless boundary crossings, but workers avoid any role that could impair judgment or exploit the client. When one is unavoidable, it must be documented and managed.

#317 · Values and Ethics

What are boundaries in a helping relationship?

Answer

Boundaries are the limits that keep the helping relationship professional and focused on the client's needs. A boundary crossing is a small slip, like a brief self-disclosure, that can be repaired. A boundary violation exploits or harms the client.

#318 · Values and Ethics

Should a social worker accept gifts from clients?

Answer

A small token of gratitude may be fine, but a large or meaningful gift can create a conflict of interest. The worker should consider the cost, the meaning, and the client's situation. When in doubt, the worker talks it through with the client and documents it.

#319 · Values and Ethics

Why must a worker report suspected child abuse even if a client objects?

Answer

Reporting suspected child abuse and neglect is a legal mandate that overrides client confidentiality. The worker tells the client about this limit up front, then makes the report. The safety of the child comes first.

#320 · Values and Ethics

What is the legal duty called mandated reporting?

Answer

Mandated reporting is a legal duty that requires certain professionals to report suspected abuse or neglect of children, and often of vulnerable adults, to authorities. It is not optional and it overrides confidentiality. Reports are made on reasonable suspicion, not proof.

#321 · Values and Ethics

When does a worker have a duty to protect someone?

Answer

When a client makes a credible and specific threat of serious harm to an identifiable person, the worker has a duty to act. Actions can include warning the person, notifying police, and increasing safety measures. The worker balances the client's privacy against someone's right to live.

#322 · Values and Ethics

What is social justice in the social work code of ethics?

Answer

Social justice is the value that pushes social workers to address social problems and unfair conditions. Workers advocate for and with vulnerable and oppressed groups. The goal is a fairer society for everyone.

#323 · Values and Ethics

What does cultural competence mean in practice?

Answer

Cultural competence is the ability to work effectively with people of different backgrounds and beliefs. It means learning about a client's culture, examining your own biases, and adapting your approach. It is an ongoing practice, not a box you check.

#324 · Values and Ethics

What does cultural humility add beyond competence?

Answer

Cultural humility is a lifelong, self-reflective stance that says you never fully know a person's culture. The worker stays open, curious, and willing to be corrected by the client. It avoids overgeneralizing from group labels.

#325 · Values and Ethics

What does practicing within your competence mean?

Answer

Workers only provide services they are trained and competent to give. When a client's need falls outside that range, the worker gets consultation, more training, or refers out. Practicing beyond competence can harm clients and is unethical.

#326 · Values and Ethics

Why is self-care an ethical responsibility for a social worker?

Answer

Burnout and impairment reduce the quality of care and can harm clients. The code expects workers to manage their own wellness and to seek help when stress affects practice. A healthy worker protects the people they serve.

#327 · Values and Ethics

What is the right to refuse treatment?

Answer

A client with capacity can refuse or stop services at any time, except in an emergency or as law allows. The worker respects the refusal and explains the risks and alternatives. It is based on the client's right to self-determination.

#328 · Values and Ethics

How does a worker handle informed consent with a minor?

Answer

A minor's consent depends on state law and on the minor's age, maturity, and type of service. Workers should try to get the minor's agreement as well as a guardian's consent. In some cases a minor can consent to certain care on their own.

#329 · Values and Ethics

How is a client's information shared within a treatment team?

Answer

Within a team, the worker shares only what is needed for the client's care. The worker explains who can see the information and follows record and privacy rules. This keeps the client's trust while still providing good care.

#330 · Values and Ethics

What should a worker consider before delivering services online?

Answer

Before online services, the worker should get informed consent that covers privacy, limits of confidentiality, and an emergency plan. Being on a platform does not automatically protect the client's information. The worker follows professional and privacy rules.

#331 · Values and Ethics

Can a worker impose personal values on a client?

Answer

A worker must not force personal, moral, or religious views onto a client. The worker stays neutral and supports the client's own choices within ethical and legal limits. When values clash, the worker uses self-awareness and may refer the client.

#332 · Values and Ethics

What forms of discrimination are forbidden in social work?

Answer

Social workers may not discriminate or refuse service based on race, ethnicity, sex, sexual orientation, age, disability, religion, or other protected status. The worker serves everyone fairly. Discrimination goes against the core values of the profession.

#333 · Values and Ethics

What are reasonable accommodations for a client with a disability?

Answer

Workers must make services accessible, such as sign language, plain language, or a space that works. Refusing to accommodate or treating someone differently because of disability is discrimination. Access is a matter of justice, not a favor.

#334 · Values and Ethics

What does non-abandonment mean in social work?

Answer

Non-abandonment means a worker does not leave a client without care once services begin. Services end when they are no longer needed or no longer help. If termination is needed, the worker prepares the client and arranges a safe handoff.

#335 · Values and Ethics

What should a worker do if a colleague is impaired or unethical?

Answer

If a worker sees a colleague who is impaired, incompetent, or unethical, the worker should first address it directly and seek to get help. If the problem continues and could harm clients, the worker must report it to the proper body. Protecting clients comes before loyalty to a colleague.

#336 · Values and Ethics

Why is self-awareness of your own identity important?

Answer

A worker should know how their own race, class, gender, and history shape their beliefs and reactions. This reduces imposed bias and helps the worker see how power shows up in a session. It is a core part of responsible practice.

#337 · Values and Ethics

What are the general steps of an ethical decision making model?

Answer

Most models say to identify the problem, know the relevant codes and laws, consider the people involved, weigh the options and their risks, decide, act, and review. The worker also consults a supervisor or peers when uncertain. It is a thinking process, not a fixed checklist.

#338 · Values and Ethics

What are the rules about romantic or sexual contact with clients?

Answer

A worker must not have a romantic or sexual relationship with a current client in any circumstance. NASW also prohibits sexual contact with former clients with no time limit, and the worker bears the burden of proving no exploitation in any claimed extraordinary exception.

#339 · Values and Ethics

Why does the worker keep accurate and honest records?

Answer

Records are the basis of care, continuity, and legal proof, so they must be accurate, timely, and honest. The worker documents only what is relevant to services and notes what really happened. Falsifying records is both unethical and dangerous.

#340 · Assessment and Planning

What does a biopsychosocial assessment gather?

Answer

It looks at a person's biological, psychological, and social side together. The worker gathers history about health, emotions, relationships, housing, and money. That full picture guides the problem and the plan.

#341 · Assessment and Planning

What is the mental status exam (MSE)?

Answer

The MSE is a structured snapshot of how a person looks and thinks right now. It covers appearance, behavior, speech, mood and affect, thought process and content, cognition, and insight. It helps spot things like psychosis or confusion.

#342 · Assessment and Planning

How do mood and affect differ?

Answer

Mood is the internal feeling the client reports, like depressed or anxious. Affect is what the worker observes in facial expression and tone. A flat affect can appear in a person who says they feel very sad.

#343 · Assessment and Planning

What does a genogram map out?

Answer

A genogram is a family tree that shows family members, relationships, and health or behavior patterns across generations. It helps the worker see patterns like conflict or addiction. It is drawn as a chart, not a chronological story.

#344 · Assessment and Planning

What is an ecomap used to show?

Answer

An ecomap is a visual chart of the client's links to outside systems such as school, work, family, or community. Different lines show whether each link is supportive or stressful. It reveals the client's resources and gaps.

#345 · Assessment and Planning

What are the key ideas of attachment theory?

Answer

Attachment theory says early bonds with caregivers shape how a person relates later. Bowlby and Ainsworth described secure, anxious, and avoidant attachment styles. These patterns help a social worker understand relationships and behavior.

#346 · Assessment and Planning

What are Erikson's main psychosocial stages?

Answer

Erikson's stages span the whole life and each has a challenge, such as trust versus mistrust in infancy and identity versus role confusion in youth. Success in each stage builds a healthy self. People can revisit earlier struggles when life demands it.

#347 · Assessment and Planning

What are Piaget's four stages of cognitive development?

Answer

Piaget described sensorimotor, preoperational, concrete operational, and formal operational stages. Children move from learning through senses to using logic and abstract ideas. A social worker uses this to match expectations to a child's age.

#348 · Assessment and Planning

What does object permanence mean in infancy?

Answer

Object permanence is knowing an object still exists when it is out of sight. It develops in the first sensorimotor stage, usually by about age two. Before that, a baby may act like a hidden toy no longer exists.

#349 · Assessment and Planning

How does delirium differ from dementia?

Answer

Delirium is a sudden, changeable confusion that often has a treatable medical cause. Dementia is a slowly declining loss of memory and thinking. A sudden change in an older adult is treated as an emergency until proven otherwise.

#350 · Assessment and Planning

What is the ecological or systems perspective?

Answer

This view sees a person inside many connected systems like family, school, work, and community. Problems come from the fit between person and environment, not only from within the person. Change can happen at any point in the system.

#351 · Assessment and Planning

What are the main parts of a treatment plan?

Answer

A treatment plan starts with the problems and strengths, then sets goals, objectives, and the services and people responsible. Goals are broad and objectives are specific and measurable. The plan is a map that gets reviewed and updated.

#352 · Assessment and Planning

What makes a treatment objective SMART?

Answer

SMART objectives are specific, measurable, achievable, relevant, and time bound. Instead of get better at coping, a worker might write practice breathing for ten minutes three times a week for a month. That way progress can be checked.

#353 · Assessment and Planning

What does a strengths based assessment focus on?

Answer

It looks for a client's strengths and resources, not only problems. The worker asks what the person is good at and what has helped before. This builds hope and uses the client's own power in the plan.

#354 · Assessment and Planning

What are common risk factors for suicide?

Answer

Risk goes up with past attempts, family history, substance use, chronic pain, isolation, access to means, and major losses. Hopelessness and a specific plan are especially serious. More risk factors together mean a higher level of concern.

#355 · Assessment and Planning

How is screening different from assessment?

Answer

Screening is a short tool that finds who may have a problem and needs a closer look. Assessment is the deeper process that names the problem and its causes. A positive screen leads to a real assessment.

#356 · Assessment and Planning

What is the PHQ-9 used to screen for?

Answer

The PHQ-9 is a short, evidence based questionnaire for screening depression. It asks about symptoms and how often they happen. It gives a score that suggests severity, but a worker still does a full assessment.

#357 · Assessment and Planning

What does person in environment focus on?

Answer

Person in environment looks at how the person, family, and community affect one another. The worker asks how the environment helps or hurts the client. It is the social work lens that centers context, not only diagnosis.

#358 · Assessment and Planning

What are the main parenting styles Baumrind described?

Answer

Baumrind described authoritative, authoritarian, and permissive styles, and later neglectful style was added. Authoritative parenting sets firm limits with warmth and generally relates to the healthiest outcomes. A social worker looks at style when parenting is part of the problem.

#359 · Assessment and Planning

What are the symptom groups of PTSD?

Answer

After trauma, a person may have re-experiencing, avoidance, negative mood or thoughts, and hyperarousal. These are responses to danger, not signs of weakness. A trauma history shapes how the worker builds safety and trust.

#360 · Assessment and Planning

How does acute stress disorder differ from PTSD?

Answer

Both follow a trauma, but acute stress disorder starts within days and lasts from three days to one month. If symptoms last longer than a month, the diagnosis may become PTSD. The worker watches the time frame and the link to the event.

#361 · Assessment and Planning

What is a collateral contact in assessment?

Answer

A collateral contact is information from someone else who knows the client, like a family member, doctor, or teacher. It adds context and checks facts with the client's permission where possible. It is one source, never the whole picture.

#362 · Assessment and Planning

What does the CAGE questionnaire screen for?

Answer

The CAGE is a short, four question screen for problem drinking. It asks about cutting down, annoyance at criticism, guilt, and using alcohol as an eye opener. It is a screen, not a diagnosis of dependence.

#363 · Assessment and Planning

How does a diagnosis differ from a social work assessment?

Answer

A diagnosis names a condition using the DSM or another classification. A social work assessment is broader and looks at the person, systems, strengths, and the problem. The worker uses both but centers the whole person and environment.

#364 · Assessment and Planning

Why assess both strengths and needs together?

Answer

The worker names both what the client needs and what they bring. This avoids labeling a person only by their deficits. An assessment that lists only problems hides the resources that make change possible.

#365 · Intervention and Practice

What is the strengths perspective?

Answer

The strengths perspective builds on what a client can do, not only what is wrong. The worker highlights skills, resources, and past wins. This raises hope and makes help feel possible.

#366 · Intervention and Practice

What makes a strong therapeutic alliance?

Answer

The therapeutic alliance is the trust and agreement between worker and client on goals and tasks. It is built through empathy, warmth, and genuineness. Research says it is one of the strongest predictors of good outcomes.

#367 · Intervention and Practice

What is empathetic understanding in practice?

Answer

Empathy is the ability to feel with and understand a client's world from their point of view. It is different from sympathy, which is feeling for someone from outside. The worker shows they get it without taking over or fixing.

#368 · Intervention and Practice

What is person centered therapy?

Answer

Carl Rogers described person centered therapy, which holds that clients grow when the worker offers empathy, unconditional positive regard, and genuineness. The client leads, and the worker creates a safe space. It is non directive and client driven.

#369 · Intervention and Practice

What is the main idea of cognitive behavioral therapy?

Answer

CBT says thoughts, feelings, and behaviors are connected. The worker helps the client notice and change unhelpful thoughts and actions. It is a short, goal based, evidence based approach for many problems.

#370 · Intervention and Practice

What are the steps of crisis intervention?

Answer

Crisis intervention starts by defining the problem and making sure the person is safe. Then the worker listens, lowers strong feelings, and helps the person use their own coping. Finally, the worker helps plan next steps and link to support.

#371 · Intervention and Practice

What is a safety plan after a suicidal crisis?

Answer

A safety plan is a written set of steps for when the crisis returns. It lists warning signs, calming things the person can do, people to call, and how to reach help. It turns a vague promise into a real plan.

#372 · Intervention and Practice

What are the five stages of change?

Answer

Prochaska and DiClemente described precontemplation, contemplation, preparation, action, and maintenance. In precontemplation a person is not ready, and in later stages they start and keep the change. The worker matches the approach to the stage.

#373 · Intervention and Practice

What does harm reduction focus on?

Answer

Harm reduction lowers harm from drug use or risky behavior without demanding immediate abstinence. It meets people where they are and values small steps like using a clean needle. It uses workable and respectful goals.

#374 · Intervention and Practice

What are the three main purposes of supervision?

Answer

Administrative supervision handles policy, workload, and accountability, while educational supervision builds the worker's skills and knowledge. Supportive supervision gives emotional support and lowers burnout. A good supervisor balances all three.

#375 · Intervention and Practice

What is transference in practice?

Answer

Transference is when a client projects feelings from past relationships onto the worker. The client may treat the worker as they once treated a parent or partner. The worker uses this as information while keeping their own reactions separate.

#376 · Intervention and Practice

What is countertransference and how is it managed?

Answer

Countertransference is when the worker's own feelings and history get stirred by a client. It can show up as overprotecting, avoiding, or feeling angry. The worker uses supervision to notice and manage it so it does not hurt the client.

#377 · Intervention and Practice

What are the typical stages of group development?

Answer

Groups often move through forming, storming, norming, performing, and adjourning. At first there is politeness, then conflict, then rules and trust, then productive work, then ending. The worker leads differently in each stage.

#378 · Intervention and Practice

What is the purpose of a mutual aid group?

Answer

A mutual aid group brings together people who share a problem or identity to help each other. The worker helps members build connection and share coping strategies. Much of the healing comes from the members, not only the leader.

#379 · Intervention and Practice

What does structural family therapy focus on?

Answer

Structural family therapy looks at family rules, roles, and boundaries as a system. The worker joins the family and helps rearrange the structure, such as putting a parent back in charge. Changing the family pattern changes the individual.

#380 · Intervention and Practice

What is evidence based practice?

Answer

Evidence based practice merges the best research, the worker's expertise, and the client's values and situation. The worker does not just pick any method and does not ignore client preference. The final choice fits the person, not only the research.

#381 · Intervention and Practice

What is the difference between process and outcome evaluation?

Answer

Process evaluation checks how the service is delivered, such as who comes and what they receive. Outcome evaluation checks the results, such as whether symptoms or problems change. They answer different questions and often go together.

#382 · Intervention and Practice

What is a single subject design?

Answer

A single subject design follows one client across phases, usually a baseline then treatment, like an A-B-A-B pattern. It lets a worker see whether change happens with an intervention. It is a small scale and useful way to test an approach.

#383 · Intervention and Practice

What is the independent variable in research?

Answer

The independent variable is the thing the helper changes or the presumed cause, such as a new therapy. The dependent variable is the outcome you measure, like anxiety level. If the result changes, the cause is a likely influence.

#384 · Intervention and Practice

What is a needs assessment used for?

Answer

A needs assessment finds out what a community or group actually needs and who is affected. The worker gathers data from surveys, interviews, and records. It grounds a service in evidence instead of guesswork.

#385 · Intervention and Practice

What is case management in social work?

Answer

Case management helps a client get and coordinate the services they need across many systems. The worker links, advocates, plans, and checks that care is working. The social worker is the bridge, not the only helper.

#386 · Intervention and Practice

Why is termination a planned stage of practice?

Answer

Termination is the planned ending of services and should be handled early and clearly. The worker reviews progress, names feelings about ending, and links the client to next steps. A good ending helps the client keep the gains.

#387 · Intervention and Practice

What does client centered goal setting mean?

Answer

The worker builds goals with the client instead of for them. The client says what matters most, and the worker helps shape it. When the client sets the goal, they are more likely to work toward it.

#388 · Intervention and Practice

Why does rapport building come first?

Answer

Rapport is the early sense of trust and connection between worker and client. It is built with warmth, respect, active listening, and honesty. Without it, even a good method is less likely to work.

#389 · Values and Ethics

Name the six core values of the NASW Code of Ethics.

Answer

They are service, social justice, dignity and worth of the person, importance of human relationships, integrity, and competence. Knowing them helps you spot what an ethics question is really testing.

#390 · Values and Ethics

What is a client's right to self-determination?

Answer

It is the right of a capable client to make their own choices about their own life, even choices the social worker disagrees with. The social worker informs and supports but does not decide for the client. Safety is the main limit to this right.

#391 · Values and Ethics

What does informed consent mean in social work?

Answer

It means the client agrees to a service after understanding its purpose, risks, benefits, limits of confidentiality, and right to refuse. It is a conversation, not just a signed form. Valid consent needs capacity, voluntariness, and enough information.

#392 · Values and Ethics

What are the three conditions for valid consent?

Answer

The client must have capacity, the consent must be voluntary and free of pressure, and it must be sufficiently informed. If any one is missing, the consent is not truly valid.

#393 · Values and Ethics

How is capacity different from competence?

Answer

Capacity is a clinical judgment a social worker makes about one specific decision at one time. Competence is a legal finding made by a court. A client can have capacity for one decision and not another.

#394 · Values and Ethics

What are two recognized limits to confidentiality?

Answer

Confidentiality can be broken when there is a serious risk of the client harming self or others, and when abuse or neglect of a child, older adult, or vulnerable person is suspected. It also ends when the client consents, or when a court or law requires disclosure.

#395 · Values and Ethics

What triggers a social worker's duty to report?

Answer

Mandatory reporting is triggered by reasonable suspicion, not by proof. You do not need evidence and you do not need the victim's permission. You report to the designated state agency such as child protective or adult protective services.

#396 · Values and Ethics

A worker suspects child abuse but is not sure. What is the first step?

Answer

Report the suspicion to the proper authority, because reasonable suspicion is enough. Do not confront the family first and do not investigate the matter yourself, as that can add risk.

#397 · Values and Ethics

Is a romantic relationship with a client ever acceptable?

Answer

No. Romantic or sexual relationships with clients are never acceptable, and most codes and laws prohibit them. Many rules also extend to former clients for a period after services end.

#398 · Values and Ethics

How is a boundary crossing different from a boundary violation?

Answer

A boundary crossing is a small, possibly harmless deviation that can be purposeful, such as brief self-disclosure that helps the client. A boundary violation exploits or harms the client and damages the relationship. The test is what effect it has on the client and the work.

#399 · Values and Ethics

When may a social worker share personal information with a client?

Answer

Self-disclosure should happen only when it serves a clear therapeutic purpose and is unlikely to harm the client. A small personal example can build rapport, while sharing your own problems is a boundary problem.

#400 · Values and Ethics

What is a conflict of interest for a social worker?

Answer

A conflict of interest is when the social worker's own interest, such as money or a personal bond, could affect judgment about a client. The worker must name it, disclose it, and protect the client, often by stepping back or bringing in another professional.

#401 · Values and Ethics

A capable older adult refuses a service the worker thinks is needed. What is the response?

Answer

Respect the client's right to self-determination and honor the choice. The social worker informs the client, addresses any safety concern, and supports the decision rather than forcing the service.

#402 · Values and Ethics

What does a guardian do?

Answer

A guardian is appointed by a court for a person who lacks capacity and has the authority to give consent on that person's behalf. This is the exception to the general rule that clients give their own consent.

#403 · Values and Ethics

What is PHI under HIPAA?

Answer

PHI, or protected health information, is any information that can identify a client, such as a name, birthdate, diagnostic code, or record number. HIPAA limits who can see PHI without permission.

#404 · Values and Ethics

What is required before sharing client information with a third party?

Answer

You need a specific, dated, signed release of information that says exactly what can be shared and with whom. Giving information over the phone without verifying consent is a common wrong answer.

#405 · Values and Ethics

What should a worker do when served a subpoena?

Answer

Consult the agency, your supervisor, and legal counsel before releasing anything. A subpoena is a legal demand, not an automatic release of the whole file, and you release only what is required.

#406 · Values and Ethics

A worker shows exhaustion and cynicism from a heavy caseload. What does this show?

Answer

This describes burnout, which is physical and emotional exhaustion from long-term work stress. It brings cynicism and detachment. The response is supervision, boundaries, and self-care, not just working harder.

#407 · Values and Ethics

What is secondary trauma in social work?

Answer

Secondary trauma, or vicarious trauma, happens when a worker absorbs the trauma that clients describe and develops symptoms like intrusive thoughts or numbness. It comes from exposure to traumatic material, unlike burnout, which is about chronic work stress.

#408 · Values and Ethics

What is self-care in social work and why does it matter?

Answer

Self-care includes balance, boundaries, breaks, supervision, peer support, exercise, and rest. It matters because burnout and secondary trauma can harm the quality of care and the worker's own health.

#409 · Values and Ethics

What is the ethical duty behind professional development?

Answer

Competence is an ongoing ethical duty, not a one-time achievement. A social worker must pursue current knowledge and training, and must seek consultation or refer when a client's needs fall outside their skills.

#410 · Values and Ethics

What is the principle of the least restrictive alternative?

Answer

The worker should use the least restrictive option that still keeps the person safe. It balances protection with a client's freedom and self-determination.

#411 · Values and Ethics

What does the value of dignity and worth of the person require?

Answer

It means treating every client with respect and honoring their right to self-determination. Even when you disagree with a client, you respect their personhood and their voice.

#412 · Values and Ethics

What does the value of social justice mean in practice?

Answer

It means working to challenge social injustice, especially for oppressed or marginalized people. On the exam this shows up as advocating to change an unfair policy rather than accepting it.

#413 · Values and Ethics

What is a microaggression toward a client?

Answer

A microaggression is a brief, everyday comment or action that sends a demeaning message to a member of a marginalized group. It can be subtle and unintended, but it still causes harm. A good response validates the experience and works to repair it.

#414 · Values and Ethics

A client from a marginalized group describes an experience of discrimination. Best response?

Answer

Validate the experience, show curiosity, and ask how it affects the client. Do not dismiss, minimize, or argue that it did not happen.

#415 · Values and Ethics

What does abandonment mean in social work?

Answer

Abandonment is ending services abruptly and without adequate notice, leaving a client without support. A social worker should not drop a client out of frustration; instead, plan the ending and give a referral and resources.

#416 · Assessment and Planning

What does the person-in-environment framework do?

Answer

Person-in-environment views the client within their family, community, and systems. It broadens assessment beyond the individual to the context that shapes them.

#417 · Assessment and Planning

What does a mental status examination assess?

Answer

It observes appearance, behavior, speech, mood, affect, thought process, thought content, cognition, insight, and judgment. It is a snapshot of current mental state, not a diagnosis.

#418 · Assessment and Planning

What is the difference between mood and affect?

Answer

Mood is the client's self-reported feeling, such as saying I feel sad. Affect is the outward expression you observe, such as flat or bright. They can be mismatched.

#419 · Assessment and Planning

What is a delusion in mental status assessment?

Answer

A delusion is a false, fixed belief that is not based in reality and that a person holds even against evidence. It is part of thought content.

#420 · Assessment and Planning

What is a hallucination in a mental status exam?

Answer

A hallucination is a sensory experience that happens without a real external stimulus, such as hearing voices. It is different from a delusion, which is a false belief.

#421 · Assessment and Planning

What is orientation in a mental status exam?

Answer

Orientation is knowing who you are, where you are, and what time it is. Confusion about these can point to an acute problem and is part of cognition.

#422 · Assessment and Planning

A client says they just want to end it all. What should the worker do first?

Answer

Assess the risk directly with specific questions about thoughts, plan, means, and timeframe. Direct questioning does not plant the idea; it is responsible, standard practice.

#423 · Assessment and Planning

What factors raise the level of suicide or violence risk?

Answer

Risk rises with a specific threat, a clear plan, available means, a history of attempts or violence, and factors like substance use, impulsivity, isolation, and access to weapons. The more specific and the greater the means, the higher the risk.

#424 · Assessment and Planning

How should a worker interview a client who uses a different language?

Answer

Speak directly to the client through a qualified interpreter rather than using a family member. Keep the conversation between you and the client, with the interpreter relaying it.

#425 · Assessment and Planning

What are open-ended questions and when are they used?

Answer

Open-ended questions invite a fuller answer, like telling me about that. They help a client open up. Closed questions get a specific fact but can shut down exploration.

#426 · Assessment and Planning

What is the transtheoretical model of change?

Answer

It describes five stages of change: precontemplation, contemplation, preparation, action, and maintenance. Relapse is a normal return to an earlier stage, not a stage itself, and you match your intervention to the client's current stage.

#427 · Assessment and Planning

A client does not see a problem at all. What stage and what should the worker do?

Answer

That is precontemplation. The social worker builds awareness and the relationship rather than pushing for change, because direct pressure usually fails at this stage.

#428 · Assessment and Planning

What is a SMART goal?

Answer

A SMART goal is Specific, Measurable, Achievable, Relevant, and Time-bound. It names who does what, by when, and how you will know it happened.

#429 · Assessment and Planning

What is the difference between a goal and an objective?

Answer

A goal is a broad statement of what the client is working toward. An objective is a specific, measurable step that shows progress toward the goal.

#430 · Assessment and Planning

What is triage in social services?

Answer

Triage is sorting needs by urgency so the most critical get attention first. You weigh severity, risk of harm, and immediacy, and you handle safety and urgent needs before routine ones.

#431 · Assessment and Planning

What does resilience mean for a client?

Answer

Resilience is the ability to bounce back from adversity. It is not a fixed trait and it can be supported by building coping skills and support.

#432 · Assessment and Planning

What does an assessment of coping look at?

Answer

It looks at how the client has coped in the past, what helped, and what did not. The worker distinguishes active coping like problem solving from avoidant coping like denial or withdrawal.

#433 · Assessment and Planning

How is active coping different from avoidant coping?

Answer

Active coping means problem solving, seeking support, and reframing. Avoidant coping means withdrawal, denial, or substance use. Active coping tends to be healthier, and the worker helps a client build it.

#434 · Assessment and Planning

Why is the mental status exam a snapshot and not a diagnosis?

Answer

The MSE is a snapshot of the client's current mental state, used as one piece of the whole assessment. It is not a diagnosis and should not be used to label the client.

#435 · Assessment and Planning

A client seems calm but reports deep sadness. What should the worker notice?

Answer

The worker notices the mismatch between mood and affect, which can be a clue to something more. Respond with curiosity rather than accusation.

#436 · Assessment and Planning

What is a service plan?

Answer

A service plan is a clear written agreement about who is responsible, what will be done, when, and how progress is measured. It should be concrete, understood, and agreed to by the client.

#437 · Assessment and Planning

What does it mean to involve the client in planning?

Answer

Problem identification and goal setting happen with the client, not for them. The client names their concerns and helps choose goals, which makes the plan more likely to be followed.

#438 · Assessment and Planning

What does a risk assessment on harm to others look at?

Answer

The worker assesses whether there is a specific person threatened, whether there is a plan, and whether there is a history of violence. This connects to the duty to warn.

#439 · Assessment and Planning

What parenting capacities does an assessment consider?

Answer

It looks at whether the parent provides a safe, nurturing environment, meets basic needs, gives structure and discipline, and responds to emotional needs. The worker observes the parent and child and weighs the child's safety.

#440 · Intervention and Practice

What is active listening in a session?

Answer

Active listening means giving full attention, reflecting content and feeling, summarizing, and asking clarifying questions. It is not just waiting for your turn to speak.

#441 · Intervention and Practice

What is reflecting in a helping interview?

Answer

Reflecting is mirroring back what the client said, often the feeling behind the words, to show understanding. It does not add new information; it tells the client you heard them.

#442 · Intervention and Practice

What is empathy and how is it different from sympathy?

Answer

Empathy is understanding and sharing the client's feelings. Sympathy is feeling sorry for a client. Empathy, unconditional positive regard, and genuineness form the conditions for a helping relationship.

#443 · Intervention and Practice

A client discloses something hard to hear. What is the best response?

Answer

Respond with empathy, acceptance, and a nonjudgmental attitude. Avoid lecturing, judging, or showing a strong personal reaction.

#444 · Intervention and Practice

What is motivational interviewing about?

Answer

It is a collaborative, person-centered method that builds a client's own reasons for change. Its core processes are engaging, focusing, evoking, and planning, built on empathy, discrepancy, rolling with resistance, and supporting self-efficacy.

#445 • Intervention and Practice

What are the four core processes of motivational interviewing?

Answer

They are engaging, focusing, evoking, and planning. The worker helps the client find their own motivation rather than arguing them into change.

#446 • Intervention and Practice

What is trauma-informed care in practice?

Answer

Trauma-informed care recognizes the impact of trauma and works to avoid re-traumatizing a client. It is built on safety, trustworthiness, choice, collaboration, and empowerment. Do not push for trauma details before the client is ready.

#447 · Intervention and Practice

What is crisis intervention used for?

Answer

It is a short-term, focused approach to help a person through an acute event. The goal is to stabilize and return the person to a baseline, not to solve every long-term problem. Safety comes first.

#448 · Intervention and Practice

What should a worker do first in a crisis?

Answer

Ensure safety and meet immediate needs, then stabilize. Do not start long-term therapy or make a permanent plan before the crisis is resolved.

#449 · Intervention and Practice

What is dialectical behavior therapy (DBT)?

Answer

DBT is a form of CBT that balances acceptance and change. It teaches mindfulness, distress tolerance, emotional regulation, and interpersonal effectiveness, and it is used for intense emotion, self-harm, and borderline traits.

#450 · Intervention and Practice

What is EMDR used to treat?

Answer

EMDR is a structured trauma therapy that uses bilateral stimulation while the client processes a memory. It is used for trauma work.

#451 • Intervention and Practice

A client has intense emotional dysregulation. Which approach is a good fit?

Answer

DBT is a strong fit because it teaches distress tolerance and emotional regulation skills. A client with distorted thinking and depression is a better fit for CBT.

#452 • Intervention and Practice

What is a defense mechanism?

Answer

A defense mechanism is an unconscious way a person protects themselves from painful feelings. Some are mature and helpful, and the exam asks you to recognize them in a scenario.

#453 · Intervention and Practice

A client blames a coworker for their own anger. What defense mechanism is this?

Answer

This is projection, attributing your own unacceptable feelings to someone else. Denial is refusing a painful reality, and displacement is redirecting a feeling at a safer target.

#454 · Intervention and Practice

A client explains a harmful act as everyone does it. What defense mechanism?

Answer

This is rationalization, creating a logical explanation for an unreasonable action. Sublimation is channeling an impulse into a socially acceptable activity.

#455 • Intervention and Practice

What is partializing in goal setting?

Answer

Partializing is breaking a large, overwhelming goal into smaller, achievable steps. It helps a client who is overwhelmed by a big problem take the first concrete action.

#456 • Intervention and Practice

What does case management involve?

Answer

Case management is coordinating services for a client: assessing needs, planning, linking to services, monitoring, advocating, and coordinating with others. The worker holds the whole picture so nothing falls through the cracks.

#457 · Intervention and Practice

What is contracting in social work?

Answer

Contracting is the agreement between the worker and client about what will happen, including goals, mutual responsibilities, and the terms of the work. It gives the work a clear frame.

#458 · Intervention and Practice

**A client is overwhelmed by a huge goal.
What is the best approach?**

Answer

Use partializing to break it into smaller steps. Do not tell the client to just handle the whole thing at once.

#459 · Intervention and Practice

A group is in the stage where members test boundaries. How should the leader respond?

Answer

This is the conflict stage. The group leader addresses the process directly and helps the group move through it, while respecting all members, rather than letting one person dominate.

#460 · Intervention and Practice

What is cohesion in a group?

Answer

Cohesion is the sense of belonging and trust in a group. It builds through stages and helps members work well together.

#461 • Intervention and Practice

A family is in conflict. What should the social worker do?

Answer

Work with the family as a system and avoid taking a side. Help the family change interaction patterns rather than solving only one member's problem.

#462 • Intervention and Practice

A client is being denied a service they are entitled to. What is the ethical action?

Answer

Advocate for the client, including through appeal or the client's rights. Do not silently accept the denial or give up.

#463 · Intervention and Practice

What does termination of services require of a social worker?

Answer

Termination should be planned and address the client's feelings, review progress, and prepare for the future. Never abandon a client; provide a referral and resources if the work is ending.

#464 · Values and Ethics

What is the difference between the HIPAA privacy rule and the security rule?

Answer

The privacy rule controls who can see and share a client's protected health information. The security rule sets technical, physical, and administrative safeguards for keeping electronic records safe. Together they decide who may look at a record and how that record is protected.

#465 · Values and Ethics

What are psychotherapy notes and how are they protected?

Answer

Psychotherapy notes are a worker's private session notes that are kept separate from the official medical record. They capture the worker's own thoughts and the content of therapy conversations. Under HIPAA they need a separate signed authorization before they can be shared, beyond a few narrow exceptions.

#466 · Values and Ethics

What is a client's right to access their own records?

Answer

Clients generally have the right to see and obtain a copy of their own record from the agency that holds it. A worker may deny access in rare cases, such as when the record would create a serious safety risk. The client can usually ask for a review of that denial.

#467 · Values and Ethics

What is testimonial privilege, and who holds it?

Answer

Testimonial privilege is a legal protection that lets a social worker refuse to testify about a client's disclosures in court. The privilege belongs to the client, so the client is the one who decides whether to waive it. A judge can set it aside when the client puts their own mental state at issue.

#468 · Values and Ethics

What is the difference between a subpoena and a court order for records?

Answer

A subpoena is a demand for records or testimony that can be issued by a lawyer, so a worker should check that it is valid and whether client consent is still needed. A court order is a judge's direct instruction and normally must be obeyed. In either case the worker releases only the minimum necessary information.

#469 · Values and Ethics

What is elder self-neglect, and is it reportable?

Answer

Self-neglect is when an older adult cannot meet their own basic needs for food, shelter, or medical care, with no other person causing the harm. Many states include serious self-neglect in their adult protective services reporting laws. The exact rules differ by state, so a worker should know their own state's definition.

#470 · Values and Ethics

What is informed consent in research, and how is it different from clinical consent?

Answer

Research consent explains a study's purpose, procedures, risks, and the fact that the client can withdraw at any time. The main difference is that research is done to create general knowledge, not to provide treatment to the client. A worker should also get a legal representative for a person with limited capacity and, when possible, the person's own agreement.

#471 · Values and Ethics

What is assent, and when does a worker get it from a minor?

Answer

Assent is a younger client's own agreement to take part after the worker explains things at the child's level. It is sought when a parent or guardian gives legal consent but the child is old enough to understand. The child's refusal should be respected unless treatment is needed to avoid serious harm.

#472 · Values and Ethics

What is a nonjudgmental attitude in practice?

Answer

A nonjudgmental attitude means a worker accepts the client as a person and holds back personal judgment about their choices. The worker still sets agreed limits and can name risks, but does not shame the client. This helps the client feel safe enough to be honest.

#473 · Values and Ethics

What is an advance directive, and how does it protect client self-determination?

Answer

An advance directive is a written record of a person's wishes for future medical care if they become unable to decide for themselves. It may name a decision maker or list specific treatments the person wants or refuses to have. Honoring it protects the client's self-determination even when they cannot speak for themselves.

#474 · Values and Ethics

What is fee-splitting or a kickback, and why is it unethical?

Answer

Fee-splitting is when a worker pays or receives a share of a fee just for sending a client, which is often called a kickback. It can push referrals based on money rather than on what the client needs. This is against most codes of ethics and is illegal in many settings.

#475 · Values and Ethics

What is the ethical rule about a personal relationship with a former client?

Answer

A social worker should not start a close or intimate relationship with a former client and should avoid any personal relationship that could harm the client. If such a relationship is being considered, the worker must review it carefully. This protects against exploiting the trust and power built during treatment.

#476 · Values and Ethics

How should a social worker handle confidentiality after a client dies?

Answer

Confidentiality usually continues after a client dies, and a worker should not release records without proper authorization. The legal personal representative or the executor may have rights to the record under state law. The worker should follow both HIPAA and the state rules that apply.

#477 · Values and Ethics

What happens when a state confidentiality law and HIPAA disagree?

Answer

A worker must follow the rule that gives the client more privacy and protection. When a state law is stricter than HIPAA, the state law is followed. When federal HIPAA is stricter, it takes over, and the stricter protection wins in either direction.

#478 · Assessment and Planning

What is the difference between a psychosocial assessment and a psychiatric evaluation?

Answer

A psychosocial assessment looks at the client's life story, relationships, strengths, and the social and environmental factors around them. A psychiatric evaluation focuses on signs, symptoms, and a mental health diagnosis, often by a medical provider. The social worker's part is the psychosocial picture, which informs but is not the same as a diagnosis.

#479 · Assessment and Planning

What is the difference between a lapse and a relapse?

Answer

A lapse is a single return to the old behavior, such as one drink after a period of sobriety. A relapse is the return of the full pattern of the problem behavior. In the stages of change, a lapse does not undo progress and should be treated as a learning event, not a failure.

#480 · Assessment and Planning

When a client is in the preparation stage, what should the worker do?

Answer

The client has decided to act within the near future, so the worker helps them turn that decision into a clear plan. Together they set small steps, talk about barriers, and line up support. The worker supports the client's commitment rather than pushing for more motivation.

#481 • Assessment and Planning

What does it mean to ask what happened to you instead of what is wrong with you?

Answer

This is a trauma-informed shift that looks for the experiences behind a client's struggles instead of labeling the person. It recognizes that many reactions are understandable responses to hard events. This reduces shame and keeps the focus on support rather than blame.

#482 • Assessment and Planning

What is grounding, and how does it help a client in distress?

Answer

Grounding is a set of simple techniques that pull a person's attention back to the present, such as naming what they see and touch. It is used when a client feels flooded, dissociates, or is overwhelmed by a memory. Grounding helps them feel calm and safe enough to stay in the moment.

#483 · Assessment and Planning

What is the scapegoat role in a family?

Answer

The scapegoat is a family member who receives the blame for problems that belong to the whole family. This role can protect the family's image and the more fragile members. The labeled member often feels rejected, but is also carrying the family's unspoken pain.

#484 · Assessment and Planning

What is differentiation of self in family systems work?

Answer

Differentiation of self is a person's ability to hold their own thoughts and feelings while staying close to others. A person with low differentiation gets pulled into family emotion and reacts automatically. A person with higher differentiation can stay calm and choose a thoughtful response.

#485 · Assessment and Planning

What is the defense mechanism of reaction formation?

Answer

Reaction formation is when a person deals with an unacceptable feeling by behaving in the opposite way. For example, a worker who is annoyed by a colleague becomes overly warm to them. The person is often unaware that the opposite behavior is covering the real feeling.

#486 · Assessment and Planning

What is the defense mechanism of regression?

Answer

Regression is a return to childlike behavior when a person is under stress. An adult might throw a tantrum, withdraw, or ask for excessive reassurance under pressure. It is an unconscious way of seeking safety and comfort.

#487 · Assessment and Planning

What is splitting as a defense mechanism?

Answer

Splitting is seeing people and situations as all good or all bad, with little in between. A client might view the worker as perfect one day and cruel the next. It protects the person from complex mixed feelings, but it strains relationships.

#488 · Assessment and Planning

What is anticipatory grief?

Answer

Anticipatory grief is grief a person begins to feel before an expected loss, such as before a loved one dies. It lets the family start to adjust and to say goodbye. It can also bring feelings of guilt or exhaustion before the death even happens.

#489 · Assessment and Planning

What is disenfranchised grief?

Answer

Disenfranchised grief is a loss that a person is not allowed to grieve openly because it is not socially recognized or supported. Examples include the loss of a pet, a miscarriage, or the end of a secret relationship. The griever may feel alone or ashamed about the depth of their pain.

#490 · Assessment and Planning

What is complicated grief, also called prolonged grief disorder?

Answer

Complicated grief is grief that stays intensely painful and does not settle into a more manageable place over time. The person may be stuck in longing, avoidance, or searching for the lost person well past the expected period. It is treated as its own condition that may need targeted support.

#491 • Intervention and Practice

What is the discrimination model of supervision?

Answer

The discrimination model describes how a supervisor picks a focus for a session based on the supervisee's needs. The supervisor helps through one of three roles: teacher, counselor, or consultant. The supervisor gives more direction when the worker is less experienced and helps the worker think more independently as they grow.

#492 • Intervention and Practice

What is relapse prevention planning?

Answer

Relapse prevention planning helps a client spot the high-risk situations, triggers, and warning signs that lead back to the old behavior. The client builds a clear plan of coping steps and people to contact. It reframes slips as problems to solve rather than reasons to give up.

#493 · Intervention and Practice

What is a logic model in program planning?

Answer

A logic model is a simple diagram that links a program's inputs, activities, outputs, and outcomes. It shows how the program is supposed to work and what it is meant to change. It is a planning and evaluation tool that keeps staff focused on the results they claim.

#494 · Intervention and Practice

What is the difference between cost-benefit and cost-effectiveness analysis?

Answer

Cost-benefit analysis puts both the costs and the benefits into money so a program can be judged by its dollar return. Cost-effectiveness analysis compares cost to a specific result, such as dollars per student who graduates. Both are used to decide whether a program is worth the money it costs.

#495 · Intervention and Practice

What is the difference between random selection and random assignment?

Answer

Random selection is how a researcher picks participants from a larger group so the sample can stand for that group. Random assignment is how those chosen participants are sorted into a treatment group or a control group. Selection affects who is in the study, while assignment affects who gets the treatment.

#496 · Intervention and Practice

What is a stratified random sample?

Answer

A stratified random sample divides the population into important groups, such as by age or region, and then randomly picks from each group. This makes sure each subgroup is represented in the sample. It helps the results reflect a varied population.

#497 · Intervention and Practice

What are the three goals of crisis intervention?

Answer

The first goal is to make sure the client and others are physically safe. The second is to stabilize the client and return them to a baseline after the shock. The third is to build coping so the client can handle the next steps, which keeps the helper focused on what is most urgent.

#498 · Intervention and Practice

What is the difference between a crisis and a psychiatric emergency?

Answer

A crisis is a time of overwhelming stress when a person's usual coping is not enough, but they are not necessarily in physical danger. A psychiatric emergency is a more urgent situation with an immediate threat of harm or a severe break from reality. Both need a quick response, but an emergency calls for a medical or safety response first.

#499 · Intervention and Practice

What is the difference between a deficit model and a strengths model?

Answer

A deficit model starts by listing what the client lacks or does wrong. A strengths model starts by finding what the client already has to work with. The strengths model does not ignore problems, but it builds the plan around the client's assets and skills.

#500 · Intervention and Practice

What is the difference between micro, mezzo, and macro practice?

Answer

Micro practice works with a single client, family, or small group. Mezzo practice works with larger groups, organizations, or communities. Macro practice works on policies and systems that affect many people at once, and social workers often move across all three levels.